

DISCIPLINE EQUALS FREEDOM

FIELD MANUAL MK1-MOD1

EXPANDED EDITION

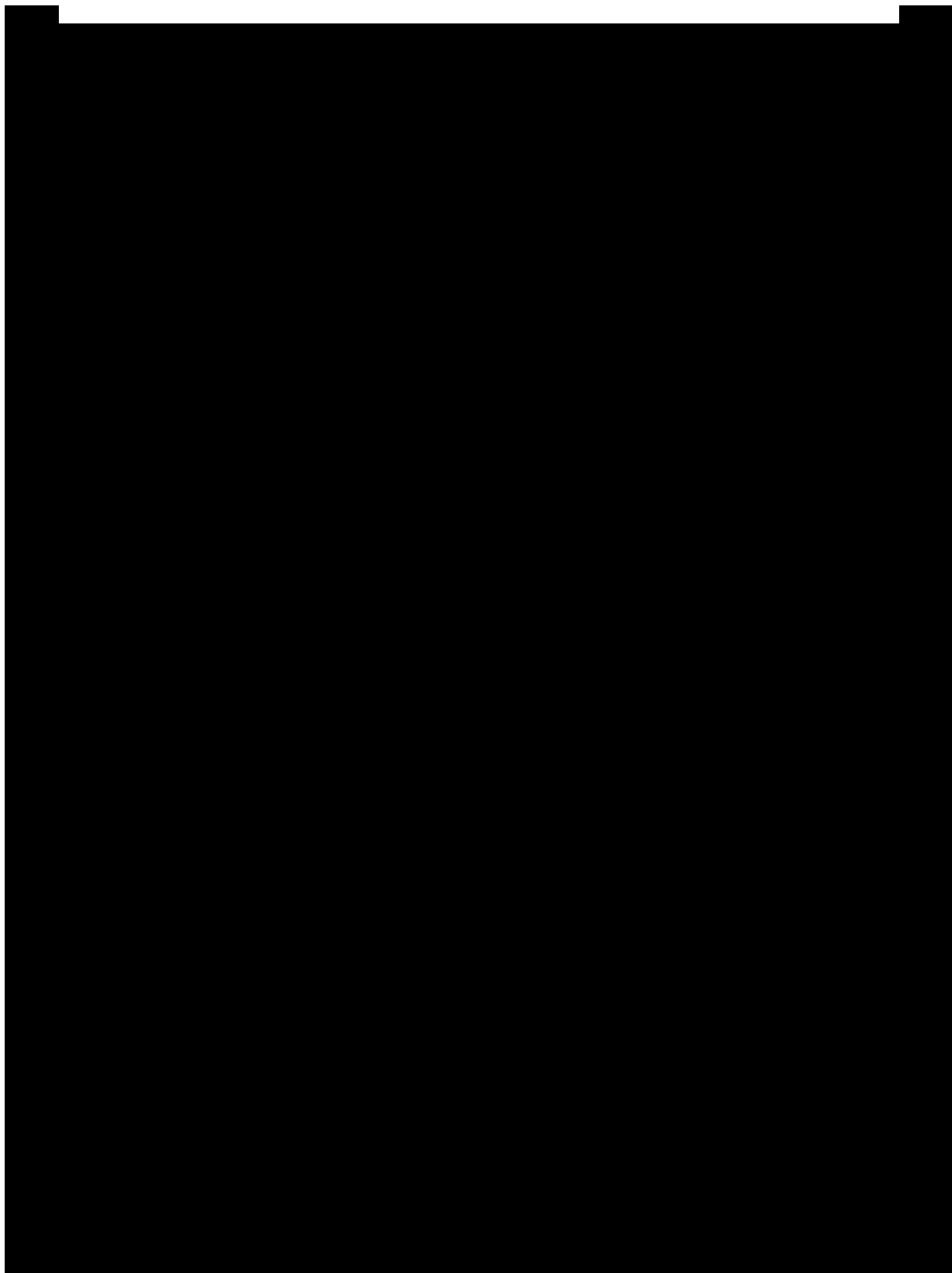


BY JOCKO WILLINK

DISCIPLINE
EQUALS FREEDOM:
FIELD MANUAL
MK1-MOD1

JOCKO WILLINK





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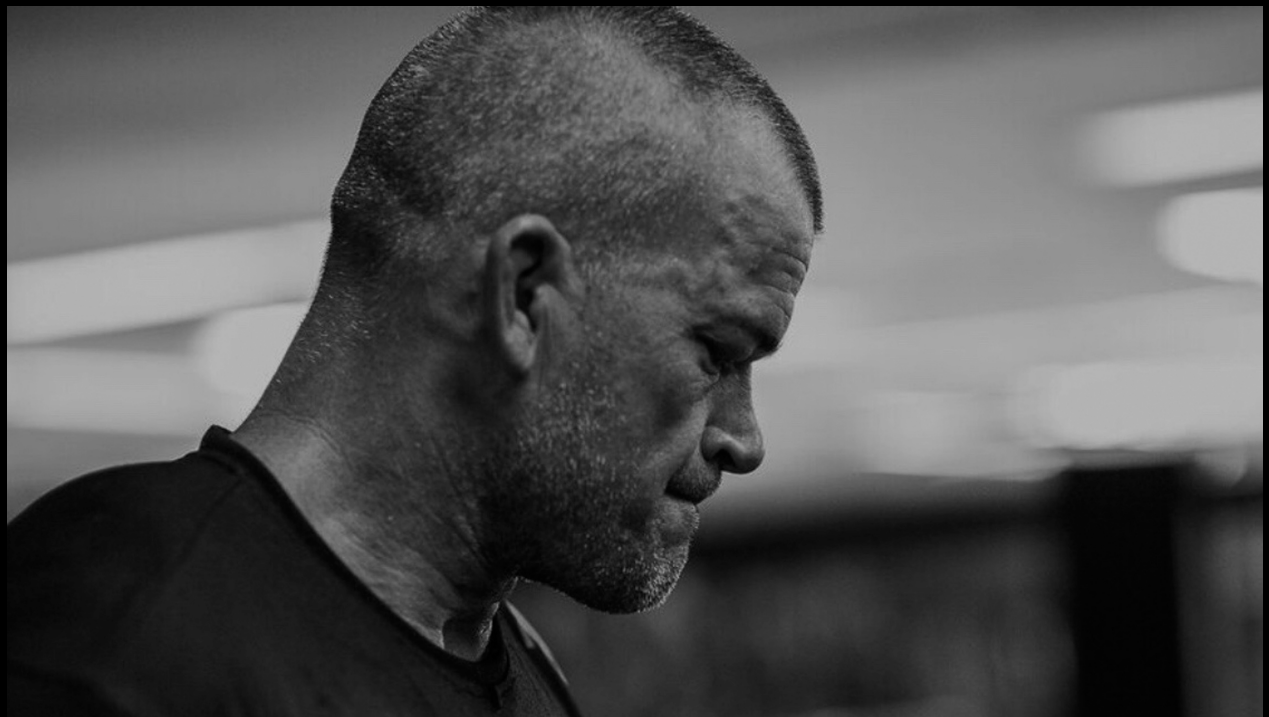
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This book is dedicated to

Marc Lee,
Mike Monsoor,
and
Ryan Job,

from SEAL Team Three, Task Unit Bruiser,
who lived, and fought, and died
as warriors.



PART 1:

THOUGHTS

THE WAY OF DISCIPLINE

People look for the shortcut. The hack.

And if you came here looking for that:
You won't find it.

The shortcut is a lie.
The hack doesn't get you there.

And if you want to take the easy road, it won't take you to where you want to be:
Stronger. Smarter. Faster. Healthier. Better.

FREE.

To reach goals and overcome obstacles and become the best version of you possible will not happen by itself. It will not happen cutting corners, taking shortcuts, or looking for the easy way.

THERE IS NO EASY WAY.

There is only hard work, late nights, early mornings, practice, rehearsal, repetition, study, sweat, blood, toil, frustration, and discipline. DISCIPLINE.

THERE MUST BE DISCIPLINE.

Discipline: The root of all good qualities.
The driver of daily execution. The core principle that overcomes laziness and lethargy and excuses. Discipline defeats the infinite excuses that say: Not today, not now, I need a rest, I will do it tomorrow.

What's the hack? How do you become stronger, smarter, faster, healthier? How do you become better? How do you achieve true freedom?

There is only one way.

THE WAY OF DISCIPLINE.

WHY

Why?

Over and over and over again, I am asked: Why?

What drives me.

When I was younger, I was preparing for war.

I knew that somewhere out there,
another man was also preparing.

That man was my enemy.

He was working, training, planning, and preparing
to meet me on the battlefield.

I didn't know when.

I didn't know where.

But I knew that at some point: We would meet.

And I wanted to be ready.

Ready mentally.

Ready physically.

Ready emotionally.

So I trained. And I prepared. And I did everything I could to be
ready for that day.

When I became a leader, I took the same approach.

To prepare my men in the same way:

To train brutally and without mercy
so we could fight brutally and without mercy.

And the day came.

We met the enemy on the battlefield.

We were ready and we fought
and we won.

Then one day, it was over.

I was no longer a soldier; no longer a leader of men.

I was no longer preparing myself or my men
for war.

So. What drives me now?

The answer is simple:

The men that did not come home.

Marc and Mikey and Ryan.

But it is not only them.

There are others.

Hundreds more.

Thousands more.

Countless more.

Who fought and died to give me the gift of freedom.

And for them,

I will make every day—every minute—every
second—I will make it all count.

I will live to honor their sacrifice—

A life worthy of the price they paid,
for me,
for us.

I will not let them down.

WHERE DOES DISCIPLINE COME FROM?

Where does discipline come from?
This is a simple answer.
Discipline comes from within.
Discipline is an internal force.

Sure, you can have discipline imposed on you by a person, like a drill instructor,
or that self-help guru on TV, but the reality is: He won't give you real discipline.

Because that external discipline is not strong. It will not survive. It cannot stand on its own.
What you are looking for,

what you need, is **SELF-DISCIPLINE**.

Self-discipline, as the very term implies,
comes from the SELF. YOU.
It comes when you make a decision
to be disciplined.
When you make a decision to be better.

When you make a decision to do more, to BE more.
Self-discipline comes when you decide to make a mark on the world.
If you don't think you are disciplined:

It is because you haven't decided to be
disciplined. **YET**.

It is because you haven't created it. **YET**.

You haven't become it. **YET**.

So where does it come from?

It comes from you.

So make the decision.

Make the commitment.

Become the discipline—embrace its cold and relentless power.

And it will make you better and stronger and smarter and faster and
healthier than anything else. And most important:

It will make you free.

OVERCOMING PROCRASTINATION: WHEN AND WHERE TO START

People want to know how to stop laziness.
They want to know how to stop procrastination.

They have an idea in their head...
Maybe even a *vision*.

But they don't know where to start—so they ask.
And they say: "Where do I start?"
"When is the best time to start?"
And I have a simple answer:

HERE and NOW.

That's it.
You want to improve?
You want to get better?
You want to get on a workout program or a clean diet or start a new business?
You want to write a book or make a movie or build a house or a computer or an app?
Where do you start? You start right **HERE**.
When do you start? You start right **NOW**.
You initiate action.
You **GO**.

Here is the reality:
That idea isn't going to execute itself.
That book isn't going to write itself.
Those weights out in the gym—they
aren't going to move themselves.

YOU HAVE TO DO IT.

And you have to do it now. So stop thinking about it. Stop dreaming about it.
Stop researching every aspect of it and reading all about it and debating the pros and cons of it...
Start doing it.
Take that first step and Make It Happen.

GET AFTER IT.

Here and NOW.

THE PERSON YOU CAN CONTROL

People are not who you want them to be. Kill your idols. Sure there are things we can learn from people—but people aren't going to be what you think they are—what they should be.

People, even those people you have put up on a pedestal, are going to be faulted, weak, egomaniacal, condescending. They are going to be lazy, entitled, shortsighted. They will not be perfect. Far from it.

That's fine. Learn from their weaknesses. Of course: Learn from their strengths and mimic and copy them in what they do well. But equally as important: Learn from their faults.

See what not to do.

Because you can't control other people. You can't make them what you want them to be. You can't make them who you want them to be.

The only person you can control is you.
So focus on making yourself who
you want you to be:

*Faster. Stronger. Smarter. More humble. **Less ego.***

Discipline your body. Free your mind. Get up early, and go.
Get after it and you will become the person you want to be.
And you become that person through:

One. Small. Decision. At. A. Time.

MIND CONTROL

When people think of the words "mind control," they think of people controlling the minds of *other* people. Not me.

I think about controlling my own mind.

Sure, we are physical beings, and we must obviously embrace our physicality.

But we are our minds.

And I'm not going to go philosophical on what that means and where the "YOU" actually is —whether it is a soul or your brain or your heart or some other conjured-up place.

What I do know is this: You, your mind, the thing that is reading and comprehending these words right now, that IS YOU.

And you can control it. You are the machine, and you can control it.

People ask me, "How do I get tougher?"

BE TOUGHER.

"How can I wake up early in the morning?"

WAKE UP EARLY.

"How can I work out consistently every day?"

WORK OUT CONSISTENTLY EVERY DAY.

"How can I stop eating sugar?"

STOP EATING SUGAR.

You can even control your emotions:

"How can I stop missing that girl or guy or whoever broke up with me?"

STOP MISSING THEM.

You have control over your mind. You just have to assert it.

You have to decide that you are going to be in control, that you are going to do what YOU want to do.

Weakness doesn't get a vote.

Laziness doesn't get a vote.

Sadness doesn't get a vote.

Frustration doesn't get a vote.

Negativity

DOESN'T GET A VOTE!

Your temper doesn't get a vote.

So next time you are feeling weak or lazy or soft or emotional, tell those feelings they don't get a vote.

You are declaring martial law on your mind:

MIND CONTROL.

Impose what you want on your brain:

DISCIPLINE.

POWER.

POSITIVITY.

WILL.

And use that Mind Control to move
your life where you want it to be:
stronger, faster, smarter, quicker, friendlier, more helpful, more
driven.

Don't let your mind control you.

Control your mind. And then you can:

SET IT FREE.

WEAKNESS

Do I have weakness?

I am nothing but weakness.

I am not naturally strong, or fast, or flexible.

I am certainly not the smartest person in the world.

I get emotional over stupid things.

I eat the wrong foods.

I don't sleep enough.

I procrastinate and I waste time.

I care too much about meaningless things and not enough about important things.

My ego is too big.

My mind is too small, often trapped inside itself.

Now all that being said, I have a saying: A person's strength is often their biggest weakness.

But, their weaknesses can become strengths.

Me? I am weak, in all those ways, I am weak.

BUT

I don't accept that.

I don't accept that I am what I am and that "that" is what I am doomed to be.

NO. I do not accept that.

I'm fighting.

I'm always fighting. I'm struggling and I'm scraping and kicking and clawing at those weaknesses—to change them. To stop them.

Some days I win. But some days I don't.

But each and every day: I get back up
and I move forward.

With my fists clenched.

Toward the battle. Toward the struggle.

And I fight with everything I've got:

To overcome those weaknesses and those shortfalls and those flaws as
I strive to be just a

little bit better today

than I was yesterday...

STRESS

First of all, and I don't mean to minimize the stress people face, but:

Imagine what Eugene Sledge went through on Peleliu and the tens of thousands of Marines there who suffered unimaginable horror. Imagine David Hackworth assaulting enemy positions in Korea, wounded over and over again on the line, still going back for more. Imagine the poet warrior Alan Seeger in World War One getting ready to go over the top and make his rendezvous with death... Imagine the thousands of warriors who have gone before you, who have stood and faced evil and death.

And now imagine you. I used to do this myself while in Iraq facing stress.

Yes, we took casualties, and yes it was awful and heartbreaking and every bit as wretched as I could imagine.

But warriors have faced much much worse: The Battle of the Somme, or Gettysburg, or the Battle of the Bulge, or the Chosin Reservoir. Humans can withstand almost inconceivable stress—and you can too. So that is your first step: Gain perspective. And to do that you must do something critical in many situations: Detach.

Whatever problems or stress you are experiencing, detach from them. Stress is generally caused by what you can't control.

The worst thing about incoming artillery fire is you can't control it. It is happening and you just have to accept it. Don't stress about things you can't control.

If the stress is something that you can control and you are not, that is a lack of discipline and a lack of ownership.

Get control of it. Impose your will to make it happen. Solve the problem. Relieve the stress.

If the stress is something you can't control: Embrace it.

You can't control it, but—

How can you look at it from a different angle?

How can you use it to your advantage?

I couldn't control the chaos of combat.

I had to embrace it.

I had to figure out a way to take advantage of it.

Make it into your ally.

So. Don't fight stress. Embrace it. Turn it on itself. Use it to make yourself sharper and more alert. Use it to make you think and learn and get better and smarter and more effective.

Use the stress to make you a better you.

DESTROYER MODE

Where does the switch come from? The overdrive. The berserker mode.
The full-on destroyer that will not stop?

I think this is something that is learned.

And it is a hard lesson and not everyone gets it.

And it is an important lesson.

A critical one.

It is the thing that allows you to go the extra distance.

To dig a little deeper.

To push a little harder.

To get after it.

And it actually takes two opposing forces to bring it to life.

It takes both *emotion* and *logic* to reach your maximum potential, to really give everything you have, to go beyond your limits.

Because emotion and logic will both reach their limitations.

And when one fails, you need to rely on the other.

When it just doesn't make any logical sense to go on, that's when you use your emotion, your anger, your frustration, your fear, to push further, to push you to say one thing: I don't stop.

When your feelings are screaming that you have had enough, when you think you are going to break emotionally, override that emotion with concrete logic and willpower that says one thing: I don't stop.

Fight weak emotions with the power of logic; fight the weakness of logic with the power of emotion.

And in the balance of those two, you will find the strength and the tenacity and the guts to say to yourself:

I. DON'T. STOP.

UNTIL THE END

Something I saw in combat that I later tried to train out of people was the tendency to relax once the primary objective of a mission was complete. I tried to train that out of them because you can't relax until the entire mission is complete.

In training, we always attacked the platoons hard on their primary objective, but we always attacked them even harder after they left the main target, once the platoons were patrolling back to base, when their minds had already gone home and "turned off."

That's when we would bring it to them. Hit them from multiple angles with all kinds of mayhem.

So they would develop the attitude and the muscle memory to keep going until the end. And even when they got back to base, we would re-task them so they had to begin planning again. It wouldn't stop. That's the mentality I wanted to instill in them:

It is never finished.

You always have more to do.

Another mission. Another task. Another goal.

And the enemy is always watching. Waiting. Looking for that moment of weakness.

Looking for you to exhale, set your weapon down, and close your eyes, even just for a moment.

And that's when they attack.

So don't be finished.

Be starting. Be alert. Be ready. Be attacking.

BE RELENTLESS.

Let the enemy stop. Let the enemy rest. Let the enemy finish.

You? Don't finish. Don't stop. Don't rest.

Not until the enemy is completely destroyed.

And even then...Turn your focus inward, on yourself, and take the opportunity not to rest...

But to make yourself *better, faster, smarter, stronger.*

Because with those goals,
nothing is ever finished.

APPLICATION OF DISCIPLINE

Discipline starts with waking up early. It really does.
But that is just the beginning;
you absolutely have to apply it to things beyond waking up early.
It is working out, every day, making yourself stronger and faster and more flexible and healthier.
It is eating the right foods, to fuel your system correctly.
It is disciplining your emotions, so you can make good decisions. It is about having the discipline to control your ego, so it doesn't get out of hand and control you.
It is about treating people the way you would want to be treated.
It is about doing the tasks you don't want to do, but you know will help you.

Discipline is about facing your fears so you can conquer them.
Discipline means taking the hard road- the uphill road.

To do what is right.

For you and for others.

So often, the easy path calls us:

To be weak for that moment.

To break down another time.

To give in to desire and short-term gratification.

Discipline will not allow that. Discipline calls for strength and fortitude and WILL.

It won't accept weakness. It won't tolerate a breakdown in will.

Discipline can seem like your worst enemy.

But in reality it is your best friend.

It will take care of you like nothing else can.

And it will put you on the path to strength and health and intelligence and happiness.

And most important, discipline will put you on the path to FREEDOM.

QUESTIONS

Knowledge is a powerful tool.

It is the master of your tools.

It is where your tools come from, because without knowledge, there is nothing.

Let's take that one step further: Knowledge is the ultimate *weapon*; it trumps all other weapons.

Thought is what wins—the MIND is what wins—knowledge is what wins.

And you gain knowledge by asking questions.

Which questions should you ask?

Simple: Question *everything*. Don't accept anything as truth.

QUESTION IT ALL.

When you don't understand a word— get out the dictionary.

When you don't understand a concept— break it down until you do.

When you don't know how something works— dig into it until you do.

Ask every question that comes to mind. That is how you learn.

And most important: Question yourself.

Question yourself every day.

Ask yourself:

Who am I? What have I learned? What have I created? What forward progress have I made? Who have I helped?

What am I doing to improve myself—today?

To get better, faster, stronger,
healthier, smarter?

Is *this* what I want to be? *This*? Is *this* all I've got—is this everything I can give? Is *this* going to be *my life*? Do I *accept* that?

Ask yourself those questions, those hard questions
and then answer them, truthfully.

And realize that all of us—ALL OF US—can do better. We can be better.

And it starts when you begin to ask those questions...

So ask the hard questions of yourself—and find the path to progress and discipline *and to freedom* inside the answers.

FIGHT

Go down swinging. And I'll tell you: If you fight with all you have, more often than not, you won't go down at all. You will win.

But you have to make that attitude a part of your everyday life.

Do the extra repetition.

Run the extra mile.

Go the extra round.

Make the right choices.

Give the full measure.

Make yourself stronger, mentally and physically.

Stand and fight.

Fight against weakness. Against fear. Against time and against decay.

FIGHT BACK.

Go down swinging.

Give every day everything you've got.

And when you face a challenge—even something you don't believe you can win, or a situation where you know you cannot win—remember this:

You have nothing to lose.

So.

STAND UP. GO FORWARD.

Go out in a blaze of glory, fighting with everything you've got, every ounce of energy, every bead of sweat, every drop of blood—until your last breath.

And then—and only then—can you stand down, put down your sword and your shield, and rest: in peace.

COMPROMISE

When working with other people and dynamic situations and relationships and deals, a person, especially a leader, must compromise.

Finding the common ground between teams.

Merging different approaches to the same problem.

Bridging personalities with people who might not get along.

Reaching agreements in courses of action.

All of these require compromise.

And in many cases, a failure to compromise is a failure to succeed.

But those are external compromises, with other people, other humans that have their own personalities and ethos and issues. And compromise is needed to unify.

So to work with them, compromise is a must.

But internally—it's different.

With myself, I have to hold the line.

There are areas within myself where I CANNOT compromise.

I am going to work hard.

I am going to train hard.

I am going to improve myself.

I am not going to rest on my laurels.

I am going to own my mistakes and
confront them.

I am going to face my demons.

I'm not going to give up, or give
out, or give in.

I'm going to stand.

I am going to maintain
my self-discipline.

And on those points there will be No Compromise.

NOT NOW.

NOT EVER.

DEFAULT AGGRESSIVE

Proactive and aggressive are similar and they are both good.
You certainly have to be proactive in the world.
You want to be dictating what happens, not responding to it.
And yes: That means creating or controlling a situation as much as you can.

But being aggressive—that means you are ready to attack.

As I always point out—this doesn't mean you walk around with your chest puffed out ready to bang heads with everyone around you.
It doesn't mean you confront people, physically or mentally, head-on and without a tactically superior plan.
It doesn't mean you go straight forward into conflict without thought and without reason.
It doesn't mean you engage in attrition warfare—no. That is almost never smart.

What it does mean is that you are going to get after it.

You are going to move fast.

You are going to think fast.

You are going to outthink and outmaneuver the enemy.

If I think the enemy is going to attack me—I'm going to attack them first.

If I think they are going to seize a piece of terrain—I am going to be there waiting for them.

If I think the enemy is going to flank me—too late—I'm already flanking them.

I don't view aggression as an outward attitude.

I view aggression as an internal character trait.

A fire in your mind that says: I am going to win.

I am going to battle and I am going to fight
and I am going to use every tool I have to
crush my enemy.

And that tool might be fists,
but it might be guile.

It might be a frontal attack,
but it might be a flanking maneuver.

It might be an undeniable display of force—
but it also might be a subtle political maneuver.

And that is what aggression is to me: The unstoppable fighting spirit. The drive. The burning desire to achieve mission success using every possible tool, asset, and strategy and tactic to bring about victory.

IT IS THE WILL. TO. WIN.

And if that kind of internal, relentless aggression is your DEFAULT MODE—

YOU WILL WIN.

NATURE VS. NURTURE

What is more important: Nature or nurture? In my opinion: Neither. I have seen people from every stratum of life.

In the military, I worked with every type of person:

Ivy League kids with silver spoons, former gangbangers, hood rats, prep school kids, kids from blue-collar families, kids from strong families and kids with no families, kids who were pampered and kids who were abused. And everything in between.

Everything.

And with all those different types of people, there were good and bad. Successful and unsuccessful.

And in working with businesses, I see the same thing: People from every walk of life. From the bottom to the top—and I have seen every type of person be successful.

So to me, it is not about nature or nurture: It is about choice.

The people who are successful *decide* they are going to be successful. They make that choice.

And they make other choices. They decide to study hard. They decide to work hard. They decide to be the first person to get to work and the last to go home. They decide they are going to take on the hard jobs. Take on the challenges. They decide they are going to lead when no one else will.

They choose who they are going to hang around
and they choose who they will emulate.

They choose to become who they want
to become—they aren't inhibited by
nature or nurture. They overcome both.

And I will tell you something else: It is never too late to make that choice.

You are never too old to decide where you are going to focus your efforts and push to make the most out of every situation.

So. Think not about what you've been through and where you were. Think about where you are going, and choose.

Choose to make yourself smarter and stronger and healthier.

Choose to work out and study and eat good food and keep your mind clean.

Don't let nature or nurture make you.

Choose to **MAKE. YOUR. SELF.**

FEAR OF FAILURE

Fear of failure.

Fear of failure can keep you from taking the risk.

It can leave you sitting there, paralyzed into not taking action.

And that is obviously bad.

But: I don't want you to overcome fear of failure.

I want you to be *afraid of failure*.

FEAR OF FAILURE IS GOOD.

Fear of failure will keep you up at night, planning, rehearsing, going over contingencies.

Fear of failure will keep you training hard.

Fear of failure will stop you from cutting corners.

Fear of failure will keep you working, thinking, striving, and relentlessly trying to be more prepared for battle.

So I want you to be afraid of failing. I fear failure.

But more important—

I want you to be horrified—

terrified—

of sitting on the sidelines

and doing nothing.

That is what I want you to be afraid of:

Waking up in six days or six weeks or six years or **SIXTY YEARS** and being no closer to your goal... You have made **NO PROGRESS**.

That is the horror. That is the nightmare. That is what you really need to be afraid of: Being stagnant.

So.

GET UP. AND. GO.

Take the risk, take the gamble, take the first step. Take action.

And don't let another day

slip

by.

THE WARPATH

The Path.

The Warpath. A Path of War.

The actual definition of "warpath" means moving toward a battle, a fight—toward war.

And that is what I am doing—and what I have always been doing. Whether it was the actual war against our nation's enemies, or the war against my own weaknesses—that is what I am doing:

Preparing.

Sharpening my sword.

Honing my skills.

Maintaining the unmitigated daily discipline: IN ALL THINGS.

And The Warpath is a path—it's a route— it leads somewhere.

Where does it lead?

Yes, it can lead to war.

And that is fine. Because I am ready; I am waiting.

But the war might not come. And that is okay.

Because The Warpath is also a war against weakness—
and so it leads to strength.

It is a war against ignorance—
and so it leads to knowledge.

It is a war against confusion—
and so it delivers understanding.

And The Warpath leads to control and to ownership of your life.

That is The Warpath—the path of fire and adversity. The path of blood and sweat and suffering. The Warpath is the interminable path of discipline—

which is why it leads to **FREEDOM.**

And beyond that—in the end—The Warpath
leads: To peace.

SUGARCOATED LIES

Yes, I know.
I know those donuts are tempting.
All those colorful sprinkles.
The cream filling.

The Glaze!
The Glorious Glaze!

And on top of all that: They are free—someone brought them in and just left them here. Right here. Right in front of me.
Surely, this must be some kind of sign, some kind of miracle—right? I mean: Food is food and if it is free—I pretty much *need* to eat it. It would be ungrateful for me to say no. Right? Right?

WRONG. DEAD WRONG.

Those donuts aren't food.

THEY ARE POISON.

Same with the chocolate chip cookies, the double Dutch chocolate cake, the can of soda, the bag of potato chips, and the pretzel-wrapped hot dogs.
All that junk isn't food. It doesn't fuel you. It kills you. It literally kills you.
It isn't going to make you stronger, faster, healthier, smarter, or better.

It's going to do the opposite.
And you know this. You know you

DO NOT NEED ANY OF THAT JUNK.

"But it's the only choice."

WRONG.

Unless you have gone an extended period of time without food, you don't need to eat.

And you definitely don't need to eat that poison.

YOU DON'T NEED TO EAT.

You don't even know what hungry is. Humans can go thirty days without food.

You can make it.

So. When those foods are tempting you, calling your name, and enticing you with their **SUGARCOATED LIES**—get angry. Get aggressive. Stand your ground in the battle and fight by saying NO. HOLD THE LINE. Hold the line for your health, your mental toughness, and to exercise your WILL—
which, I promise, is stronger than the will
of a donut—
if you want it to be.

HOLD THE LINE.

BAD INSTINCTS

There is one instinct to be wary of— one that you must fight.
This one is a liar.
This one is a saboteur—a backbiter.
And—like the devil himself—he's a shape-shifter..
He will disguise himself...make you think that he has got your best
interests in mind. But he doesn't.
This is the instinct that says:

YOU'VE HAD ENOUGH.

You've given it your best shot.
You can stand down.
You can back off.
You can take a knee.
This is the instinct that says: You can rest now.
Do not listen to that instinct.

DO NOT LISTEN.

Because that instinct is a liar and wants to bring you down.
You see, this instinct is a defense mechanism for your ego.
It gives you an out—a place to run to.
A place of sympathy and amnesty, where all
can be forgiven.
Where failures gather together in comfort and drown their sorrows in
lies and deception.
They tell each other—and they tell you: "You did the best you could..."
and "The deck was stacked against you..." and "It's not your fault..."
And so they tell you: It's okay to stop—it's okay to settle. *IT'S
OKAY TO GIVE UP.*
And that is the instinct you need to fight.
To push back—
to smash into the ground.

DO NOT TAKE THE EASY WAY OUT. Do not give up based on instinct. If
you are forced to stand down—to retreat so that you can rebuild and
re-attack—so be it. But make that decision based on logic—not on the
instinct of surrender and defeat. Destroy that instinct.
Replace it with the instinct that says:

GET UP. GO. FIGHT ON.

Make that your fundamental reaction to adversity—MAKE THAT YOUR GUT
INSTINCT—

and you will overcome anything that
stands in your path.

NOT FEELING IT

How do I handle those days when I'm just not "feeling it"?
Those days when I am tired or worn out or just sick of the grind...
What do I do on those days?

I GO ANYWAY. I GET IT DONE.

Even if I am just going through the motions—
I GO THROUGH THE MOTIONS.

Don't *really* want to work out? I work out.
Don't *really* want to hammer on a project?
I hammer on the project.
Don't *really* want to get up and get out of bed?
I GET UP AND GET OUT OF BED.

Now—these could be signals that you need some time off—and those
signals might be right.

BUT—don't take today off. Wait until tomorrow. Don't give in to the
immediate gratification that is whispering in your ear.

SHUT THAT DOWN. DO NOT LISTEN.

Instead: Go through the motions. Lift the weights. Sprint the hill.
Work on the project. GET OUT OF BED.

I don't like procrastination. But if you feel like you need a break—
that is one thing you should procrastinate.

Taking a break is the one thing I put off until tomorrow.

And if—when tomorrow comes—you still feel like you need rest or you
need a break—then go ahead: Take it.

Chances are you won't—you won't need that rest.

Chances are you will realize that the desire to rest was just
weakness—it was the desire to take the path of least resistance—the
downhill path—the downward path.

And by going through the motions, you overcame that weakness.

And you stayed on the righteous path—the disciplined path—

You stayed on The Warpath.

Right where you know you belong.

REGRET

Regret. The things I could have done differently or learned sooner. There's so much knowledge out there, so much information, so many ways to get better.

And we make so many mistakes.

We are the product of our mistakes.

And oftentimes the lesson is sitting in front of our face: There to be learned.

But we miss it or we don't pay attention to it or we think we know better.

Until it punches us in the face:

The most important thing to learn is that *we have so much to learn.*

We all do. And we can learn from school and people and experience and life.

But you have to process the information. Absorb it. You have to accept it. You have to open your mind—**FREE YOUR MIND**—so that you can learn and make real progress.

Are there things I regret and things I wish I had done differently? Of course. Hindsight is 20/20 and looking back, who wouldn't want to take another go at something and improve by doing it again? And then why not do it again, and again, and again?

Who wouldn't want to do things over until you have it perfect?

But the fact is: You don't get that chance. You get one shot.

We get one shot at this gig right here: Life.

One life—that's all we've got.

And the most important thing to understand about regret is that in and of itself, regret is worthless. It does nothing for you.

In fact: The only thing valuable in regret is the lesson you learned. The knowledge you gained.

But walking around filled with regret gets you nothing.

So. Learn and move on.

Don't let regret beat you down. Don't be a slave to regret.

NO.

Let it teach you. Let it make you better. Let the fear of regret fuel you—to take action—

today—now.

Take action now to become a person not filled with regret,
but a person filled with knowledge and
strength and power

and life.

FOCUS

In combat, focus comes pretty easily because the battle is right in front of your face.

You have no choice but to focus.

But, sometimes, in day-to-day life, you can lose track of the long-term goal. It fades from your vision. It slips from your mind.

WRONG.

I want that long-term goal to be so embedded in my mind, that I never lose sight of it.

EVER.

And the little tasks and projects and short-term goals that you tackle need to lead toward strategic victory—winning the long war.

But we want results **NOW**. We want the shortcut to the winner's podium. We need the instant gratification.

And when we don't get the short-term glory, sometimes we lose sight of those long-term goals. They *fade*. We lose *focus*.

So we stop the daily tasks and the daily disciplines that will allow us to achieve our goals. And a day slips by. And then another day. And a day turns into a week and a week into a year.

And you look up in six weeks or six months or six years...

And you've made no progress:

None.

You never moved. In fact: You might be even further from your goal than you were when you started. You might have gone backward.

Why? Why did you let that happen?

Because you lost sight of it.

You lost sight of the long-term goal. And it faded. It faded from memory and the passion dried up and you began to rationalize:

Maybe I can't. Maybe I don't really want to.

Maybe this goal isn't for me.

And so you give up. You let it go. And you settle.

You settle for the status quo. You settle for the easy road. You settle for "oh well."

No.

Don't do that. Embed that long-term goal in your mind. Burn it into your soul.

Think about it, write about it, talk about it. Hang it up on your wall.

But most important: Do something about it. Every day. Every day: Do something that moves you toward that goal—that keeps that goal alive and in sight and in focus.

However small or insignificant that step might seem—take it. Do it. Make it happen. Because that goal isn't going to achieve itself.

It is All. On. You.

HESITATION

*"Between the acting of a dreadful thing
And the first motion, all the interim is
Like a phantasma or a hideous dream."*

That is Brutus, from Shakespeare's *Julius Caesar*, who, in the play, is plotting to kill Caesar—someone he was loyal to. And Shakespeare—the master of understanding human nature—captures what that feels like. This is how Shakespeare's words would translate today:

"Between the acting of a dreadful thing..."
Between the moment when you are waiting to do something that you don't want to do...
"And the first motion..."
and the moment when you initiate the action...
"All the interim..."
The whole time you are waiting to take that action...
"Is like a phantasma or a hideous dream..." is like an evil spectre, an apparition—a nightmare.

So the battle, the struggle—the hesitation—takes place in that moment.
That moment, when we must step into the unknown—that moment filled with fear and horror.
And that fear is what causes hesitation—and hesitation causes defeat.

HESITATION IS THE ENEMY.

Hesitation allows the moment to pass, the opportunity to be lost, the enemy to get the upper hand. Hesitation turns into cowardice. It stops us from moving forward, from taking initiative, from executing what we know we must.
Hesitation defeats us. So we must defeat it.

To win, all you have to do is overcome that moment: The Waiting. The Hesitation. And to do that, all you have to do is: Go. Move. Take the action. Get out of bed. Get your feet on the ground. Step forward. Do not hesitate.

Do not wait.

Go forward: And win.

DRAW FIRE

Sometimes, bad things happen to good people.
I don't know why. Life is not fair. That is the reality.
Disease and accidents don't care if their victim is a "good person."
They have no reason, no justification, and no mercy.
And even the best person you know can end up in the clutches of evil.
And you cannot stop it.
So. *What do you do?*
Are you going to get angry? Frustrated?
Are you going to lash out at people?
Who are you going to lash out at?
Are you going to start going down the spiral of negativity?
Are you going to let the horrible situation dictate the way you feel
and the way you handle it?
Are you going to fall over?
Fall down?
Fall apart?

Or are you going to lead?
Are you going to face this issue with courage and with resolution?
I say: Lead.

Lead.

Step up. Be the one who people look to.
Absorb the impact—and the negativity.
Draw fire—yes: Draw fire.
That's when a member of a platoon—for tactical reasons—steps into the
open to draw enemy fire; maybe to give another part of the team a
chance to move; maybe to distract the enemy; maybe to help the
platoon locate the enemy.
But that's what I say: Draw fire. Bring that pain to me—
I can handle it when others cannot.
When bad things are happening—I will be the one good thing—standing
tall—that can be relied upon. I will bolster those around me. And the
positive attitude will spread. And we will fight. And in fighting, we
will win. If not the battle and if not the war—we will win:
Because our spirit will never surrender.

And that is the ultimate victory: To hold your head high, and—even in
the face of inescapable defeat—
To Stand and Fight.

GOOD

How do I deal with setbacks, failures, delays, defeats, or other disasters? I actually have a fairly simple way of dealing with these situations, summed up in one word: "Good."

This is something that one of my direct subordinates, one of the guys who worked for me, a guy who became one of my best friends, pointed out. He would pull me aside with some major problem or some issue that was going on, and he'd say, "Boss, we've got this thing, this situation, and it's going terribly wrong."

I would look at him and I'd say: "Good."

And finally, one day, he was telling me about something that was going off the rails, and as soon as he finished explaining it to me, he said, "I already know what you're going to say."

And I asked, "What am I going to say?"

And he said, "You're going to say: 'Good.'"

He continued, "That's what you always say. When something is wrong or going bad, you just look at me and say, 'Good.'"

And I said, "Well. I mean it. Because that is how I operate." So I explained to him that when things are going bad, there's going to be some good that will come from it.

Oh, mission got canceled? Good. We can focus on another one.

Didn't get the new high-speed gear we wanted?

Good. We can keep it simple.

Didn't get promoted? Good. More time to get better.

Didn't get funded? Good. We own more of the company.

Didn't get the job you wanted? Good. Go out, gain more experience, and build a better resume.

Got injured? Good. Needed a break from training.

Got tapped out? Good. It's better to tap out in training than to tap out on the street.

Got beat? Good. We learned.

Unexpected problems? Good. We have the opportunity to figure out a solution.

That's it. When things are going bad: Don't get all bummed out, don't get startled, don't get frustrated. No. Just look at the issue and say: "Good."

Now, I don't mean to say something trite; I'm not trying to sound like Mr. Smiley Positive Guy. That guy ignores the hard truth. That guy thinks a positive attitude will solve problems. It won't. But neither will dwelling on the problem. No. Accept reality, but focus on the solution. Take that issue, take that setback, take that problem, and turn it into something good. Go forward. And, if you are part of a team, that attitude will spread throughout. Finally: if you can say the word "good," then guess what? It means you're still alive. It means you're still breathing. And if you're still breathing, that means you've still got some fight left in you. So get up, dust off, reload, recalibrate, re-engage—and go out on the attack.

DEATH

But how does "good" apply to the worst of losses: the death of a loved one? It is easy to think that there is nothing "good" in death. But then I remember the people I have lost throughout my life: the memories of them, the experiences, the fun, their unique personalities, and everything they gave me. Not only in their life, but in their death.

What their life taught me, and what their death taught me.

The mark they have left on me.

And I realized, there is good; even in death there is good.

First of all, I was lucky to have had that person in my life; even if it was only for a short time—too short a time—at least I got that. Those precious moments, those unforgettable memories, at least I got those and got to experience those times—to know the beauty of their personality, their attitude, their outlook on the world. They were all unique, and I am thankful for the opportunity I had to interact with them.

Now, comes death.

Death is horrible and death is wretched and death is cruel. And:

Death isn't fair.

And I don't know why the best people seem to be taken from us first.

Death is also inescapable. There is no way out. No one gets out alive.

Death is part of life, like the contrast between the darkness and the light.

Without death, there is no life.

And the people that I have lost: They taught me that.

They taught me how precious life is.

How blessed we are to have every day. *To learn. To grow. To laugh. To live.*

To Live.

To live every day with purpose and passion.

To wake up in the morning and be thankful—thankful for that morning—thankful for that opportunity to go into the world and live.

Live for them. For those who don't have the opportunity.

For those who were stolen away by
death's cruel hand.

For them, I will live. I will revere their memory and I will live.

So. Let us cry no more. Let us mourn no more.

Let us remember—but let us not dwell...

Instead: Let us laugh and love and let us embrace and venerate
everything that life is and every opportunity it gives us.
Let us *LIVE*—for those WHO live no more.

Let us live to honor them.

EVERY DAY

This isn't a part-time gig.
This isn't punch the clock and go home for the day.
You don't get weekends off.

No.

Here: There's no such thing as a weekend.
This is an everyday gig: Every day is a Monday.
And you might not like that.

Me? I love it.
To me, every day is a beginning.
A new day.

A new week.

A new shot at life.

An opportunity to come out of the gate like a man possessed and
attack the day:
Without mercy.

Today: I'm taking scalps.

I'm putting the pressure on.
 I'm the aggressor.
 I'm on the attack.

And of course: I will get tired.
 I will get beat up.
 I will get knocked down and drained and will have some
bad days.
But I

will
 not

Stop.

NO MORE

No more.

No more.

NO MORE.

No more excuses.

No more: "I'll start tomorrow."

No more: "Just this once."

No more accepting the shortfalls of my own will.

No more taking the easy road.

No more bowing down to whatever unhealthy or unproductive thoughts float through my mind.

No.

No more.

No more waiting for the perfect moment

and no more indecision

and no more lies.

No more weakness.

No.

No more.

Now is the time for strength.

And through strength—

and through will—

and through unwavering discipline—

I will become *what* I want to be.

I will become *who* I want to be.

And then—and only then—will I rest and say:

No more.

STAYING MOTIVATED

Don't worry about motivation.

Motivation is fickle. It comes and goes.

It is unreliable and when you are counting on motivation to get your goals accomplished—you will likely fall short.

So.

Don't expect to be motivated every day to get out there and make things happen. You won't be.

Don't count on motivation.

Count on Discipline.

You know what you have to do.

So:

MAKE YOURSELF DO IT.

You do that with Discipline.

Everyone wants some magic pill—some life hack—that eliminates the need to do the work.

But that does not exist.

No.

You have to do the work.

You've got to hold the line.

You've got to MAKE IT HAPPEN.

So.

Dig in.

Find the Discipline.

Be the Discipline.

ACCOMPLISH.

That's it.

ME VERSUS ME

There are people in the world who have skills and strength and talent that I will never have. Never.

These notions that you can "be whatever you want to be as long as you want it bad enough" are not true. They are fairy tales.

We all have limitations. I don't have the right genes to be an Olympic weightlifter. I don't have the right genetics to be an Olympic sprinter. Or gymnast. Sure, if I trained my whole life, perhaps I could have become fairly decent in those sports.

But the best in the world? No. I simply do not have the DNA to be the best in the world in those categories.

But what does that mean? Does that mean I give up? Does that mean I quit?

Of course not. Not at all.

It means that I am going to try to be the best that I can be.

The strongest.

The fastest.

The smartest human being that I can become.

That is what I am going to go for. And it doesn't matter that I will not be better than others when I compare myself to them. No, I will look at others who do achieve greatness in a category, and I will say:

Look at what is possible.

How close can I get to that greatness?

How close can I get to that glory?

But my glory, it doesn't happen in front of a crowd.

It doesn't happen in a stadium or on a stage.

There are no medals handed out.

It happens in the darkness of the early morning.

In solitude.

Where I try. And I try. And I try again.

With everything I have, to be the best that I can possibly be.

Better than I was yesterday.

Better than people thought I could be.

Better than I thought I could be.

Faster and stronger and smarter.

And claim one victory that no one can ever take away from me. Ever.

A victory that is earned every single day.

A victory of determination and will and discipline.

A victory achieved because:

I will not stop.

REMAIN VIGILANT

It wasn't in a war.

It wasn't in a battle.

It isn't in a melee of fire and destruction that most of us succumb to weakness.

We are taken apart, slowly.

Convinced to take an easier path.

Enticed by comfort.

Most of us aren't defeated in one decisive battle.

We are defeated one tiny, seemingly insignificant surrender at a time that chips away at who we should really be.

It isn't that you wake up one day and decide that's it: I am going to be weak.

No. It is a slow incremental process. It chips away at our will—it chips away at our discipline.

We sleep in a little later.

We miss a workout, then another.

We start to eat what we shouldn't eat and drink what we shouldn't drink.

And, without realizing it—one day, you wake up and you have become something that you never would have allowed.

Instead of strong—you are weak.

Instead of disciplined—you are disorganized and lost.

Instead of moving forward and progressing—you are moving backward and decaying.

And those things happen without you seeing them.

Without you recognizing them.

So.

You *have to* **BE VIGILANT**. You have to be **ON GUARD**.

You *have to* **HOLD THE LINE** on the seemingly insignificant little things—

things that shouldn't matter—but that **do**.

FEAR

Fear is normal.

Every person feels fear at some point.

What should you do?

Step.

Step.

Take the step.

Step aggressively toward your fear—that is the step into bravery.

We are scared of what we don't know, and there is but one way to confront that fear:

Step. GO.

And that simple action, this simple attitude answers so many questions.

How do you get to the gym every day?

Step. GO.

How do you change your diet?

Step. GO.

How do you overcome fear of failure or fear of success or fear of fear itself?

Step. GO.

How do you face the fear of the unknown?

Step. GO.

Don't wait anymore.

Don't think anymore.

Don't plan anymore.

Don't contemplate anymore.

Don't make any more excuses or justifications.

Don't rationalize anything else.

No. No. **NO. NO.**

Instead: Be aggressive.

Take action.

Now.

And the first action you need to take?

The first step you need to take?

The first step you need to take is just that:

Step.

Step.

Go.

Now.

THE DARKNESS

The sun doesn't shine every day.

The storms will come.

There are times when the nights will be long and dark and you will be alone.

There will be times when The Darkness seems to consume everything.

But don't let it consume you.

Don't let it *consume* you.

Even in the darkest times.

Even in the strongest storms.

Even when the sun is blotted out and the world is falling apart.

The Darkness cannot extinguish your light.

You.

Your WILL. Your determination.

No matter what is happening—no matter how hard the fight is.

As long as you keep fighting—you win.

Only surrender is defeat.

Only quitting is the end.

Because The Darkness only wins if you let it.

Do not let The Darkness win.

Fight.

Fight on.

To fight against The
Darkness is to win.

Fight on.

OVERWHELMED

Yes. Life can be overwhelming.

That's the way life works. It is testing you.

It is going to throw problems at you and it is going to throw them at you all at the same time. This is the way life works: Murphy's Law.

It is easy to feel beaten when you are faced with all those problems at once.

But let me tell you, that does not mean give up fighting.

In fact: It means the opposite.

It is time for you to fight harder.

To dig in.

To go on The Warpath.

To assess what the problems are, and decide which one you are going to attack first. Then, get started.

Attack.

And listen: It won't be easy.

In fact: It will be hard.

Life is hard.

That's what *life* is.

And these challenges you face, they are going to do their best to
Take

you

down.

DO NOT LET THEM.

Stand up. *Dig in.*

Line up those problems and confront them—
face them—fight them.

DO NOT LET THEM BRING YOU DOWN.

Instead, let these challenges raise you up—let them elevate you.

Let their demands and their trials make you stronger—let the

adversity you face today turn you into a better person tomorrow.

So in the future, you look back at these struggles and you say to them:

Thank you—

you made me better.

NEGATIVE TALK FROM NEGATIVE PEOPLE

The old classic. What do you do about the negative person talking behind your back and trying to bring you down?

Sure you can *confront* them and join them in their little game.

You can give them the satisfaction of knowing that they got *in your head*.

You can turn your life into a grade school gossip hall.

Of course, there are times, unfortunately, that you have to engage with people like this. You may have to set the record straight on a serious allegation. You may have to challenge statements that might be damaging to the team or the mission.

And when you do have to engage, do it professionally. Say something like:

"I heard you had some pointers for me about how I'm doing my job. I'd love to get your feedback so I can tighten up my game."

A statement like that will likely diffuse the scenario. The person will know that there are informants who will tell you what is going on. And that will likely stifle the situation.

But let me tell you what my preferred methodology is for this situation:

It is simple:

Ignore and outperform.

Yes. While you are over there watching me and talking about me—*I'm working*.

I'm working hard. *I'm taking* things to the next level.

You keep gossiping—*I'll keep working*.

You keep talking smack—*I'll keep working*.

You keep chattering about things—*I'll keep working*.

You keep focusing on what everyone else is doing wrong—*I'll keep focusing* on what I can do RIGHT.

And when you finally look around at where you are and where I am —you will realize that you have nothing to talk smack about.

Because you will lose.

And I. Will. Win.

And this applies to when people are playing office politics or forming their cliques or working their personal agendas. Of course—sometimes you have to play those games too. But when dealing with people like this, let your first course of action and the fundamental core of how you handle it be very clear and very direct:

Outwork and **outperform** every last one of them.

HOLD THE LINE

Instead of going backward—instead of decaying—get stronger.

Get better.

Grow and learn and develop—and live.

Live in defiance of the weakness and in rebellion against the decay.

Fight them as they creep in with their offers of instant gratification and immediate rewards.

Fight them for every inch they try to take.

Do not surrender any ground.

EVER.

BEGIN

This is where it begins.

In the darkness.

Before the sun and the birds and the world.

Every day.

When the alarm sounds.

IT IS TIME.

Rise.

Despite fatigue and soreness.

Curse the warmth of the bed.

Curse the comfort of the pillow.

Fight the temptation of weakness.

Get up and go.

Do it quickly, without thought.

Do not reason with weakness. You cannot.

You must only take action.

Get up

and **GO.**

ENGAGE

Engage.

Weakness is strong.
I must be *stronger*.

I must crush it into submission.
Through force of will.

So. I savage the body.
I push and pull and fight against gravity.

I fight against fatigue and soreness and the weakness that says:
Give in.

I will not give in.

I will fight.

LAUGHTER WINS

Sure there is darkness everywhere.
And I have seen my share.
But that is not where I live my life.
At all.
In fact, the opposite is true.
I am not wandering around, suffering in despair.

No.

I am having fun.

FUN.

I am laughing.
I am joking.
I am clowning around making fun of everything and everyone.
Especially of myself.
I'm an easy target to poke fun at. And I'm good with that.
Because, sure: Life is tough.
But it gets a lot easier when you are laughing at it.

So.

Despite the suffering.
In fact:
To spite the suffering.
 To spite the hardships.
 To spite the challenges.
Laugh at them all.

They can't stand it when you do.
And they all get easier.
Yes: Laugh at them all.

Laughter wins.

BINARY CODE

Machines make their decisions based on binary code.

Yes or no.

It is not complicated.

Are you going to work out?

Yes or no.

Are you going to get up?

Yes or no.

Are you going to get off the couch?

Yes or no.

Are you going to eat that donut?

Yes or no.

This is not complicated.

And sometimes you have to put yourself into this mode:

Binary Decision-Making.

Are you going to be weak or strong?

Are you going to be healthy or unhealthy?

Are you going to improve your life? Are you going to make it worse?

Are you going to sacrifice long-term success for short-term gratification?

You know the right answers.

You know the right decision.

Don't overcomplicate.

Binary Decision-Making.

Make the right decisions.

DETACH

One of the most powerful things you can do as a human being is learn to detach.

Detach from your ego.

Detach from your emotions.

Detach from your perspective.

Detach from yourself.

How do you detach?

First: Recognize that you need to detach.

Recognize that your ego is a trap. While it is a force that can drive you to success, if it gets out of control, it can drive you crazy.

You must detach from your ego.

Recognize that emotions lead to bad decisions and bad behavior.

You must detach from your emotions.

Recognize that you must detach from your perspective. Sure: Your perspective is important.

But once you have seen it, you have seen it. Continuing to look at something from the same perspective doesn't advance your knowledge or your viewpoint. You have to see things from perspectives other than your own.

You must detach from your perspective.

There are indicators that tell you that you need to detach. If you start to feel your emotions boiling over that means you need to detach. Pay attention to your voice: Are you raising it? Pay attention to your body: Are you clenching your fists or grinding your teeth? Are you breathing heavily? These things mean that you are getting emotional. So, you need to detach.

Are you getting angry or jealous or frustrated? Those feelings are likely driven by your emotions. So, you need to detach.

Are you feeling stuck or trapped? Do you feel like no one understands you? If you have those feelings, you likely need to change your perspective. Which means you need to detach.

Once you recognize that you need to detach: Take a step back. Physically change your perspective by stepping back. Put your hands at your sides. Lift your chin just a little bit. This opens your airway and forces you into a slightly vulnerable physical posture—a posture that is the opposite of a fighting posture, with chin tucked down, head lowered, and hands up. Instead of being in a defensive and protective mindset, your mind will be open—open to different perspectives. Your ego will be exposed. Now look around—physically turn your head and take in your surroundings. Take some nice, big, slow breaths. Inhale deeply and exhale fully. Listen. Yes: Instead of talking, just listen.

These steps should start you down the path of being detached. As you practice these methodologies, you will get better at them. Eventually, you should be able to detach mentally without needing to detach physically by taking a step back or lifting your head or even looking around. You will be able to detach in your mind, and that will be enough.

One last note: If you are going to speak but you want to remain detached, instead of making a statement try asking a question in a calm, controlled voice. A statement plants you into the ground and removes your maneuverability; you become attached. A question keeps your mind open and allows you to remain detached.

When you are detached from your emotions and ego and when you see things from other perspectives you are able to stay calm, see more, and make better decisions.

To be better and do better: Detach.

SELF-SABOTAGE

I hear this term getting thrown around.

"Self-sabotage."

The idea is that you get "scared to win"
so you do things that make you fail.

"Every time he/she gets close to winning,
they self-sabotage and come up short."

NO.

This is garbage.

You aren't scared to win.

You are scared to work.

Guess what? Winning takes **work**. It takes *effort*. It takes *grind*.

Failure to do the work isn't "self-sabotage."

It is just plain old-fashioned

"LAZY."

DON'T BE LAZY.

ALL YOUR EXCUSES ARE LIES

You tell yourself lies. Little lies. Reasons.

It's just this once.
Today isn't important.
I already worked out yesterday.
I'm too sore.
I'm too tired.
I'm over-trained.
I need rest.
I'm too hungry.
I'm too full.
Something else is more important.
I don't have time.

LIES.

LIES.

LIES.

LIES.

People ask where discipline comes from.

I tell them it comes from within.

But there is a level deeper.

Discipline comes from The Truth.

The Truth is the framework of discipline.
And if you lie to yourself, you will
not find discipline.
If you lie to yourself, you will
not be disciplined.

And sometimes I meet people and they say:
"Well, I've gotten to a point where I'm doing well professionally.
I'm making good money. My health is pretty good. So I'm pretty happy
with where I'm at and I feel content with what I've done and I just
can't find the motivation to take it to the next level."

So I ask them: "Are you sure you really want to take it to the next
level?"

And they say: "Yes."

And I say: "I DON'T THINK SO. You see, if you really wanted to take it to the next level, you wouldn't be asking this question. You would be out there getting after it. You wouldn't have to try to find discipline. No. Discipline would find you. So you are lying to yourself. Saying you want more. Saying you want to go to the next level. If you really wanted it, you would go get it."

The person then looks disappointed. They feel like maybe they aren't truly driven.

Then I continue: "But here is the reality. If you were truly happy and if you were truly content, you wouldn't be asking these questions. Those are the lies. The truth is that you know. You know.

You know you could do more. You know you could give more. You know you could go harder. You know you could be more. And that is what is driving you crazy. That is why you ask this question. Because if you tell yourself the truth—the unfiltered, unbridled, and unmitigated truth—that you have so much more potential and that you could become so much more. If you tell yourself that truth, the discipline will find you and you will not be able to get it out of your system. Stop lying to yourself. The Truth is the fuel behind the discipline. The Truth is what makes discipline unavoidable. The Truth delivers discipline. Discipline Equals Freedom. So: The truth will set you free."

No one responds when I tell them this.

They just nod their heads.

Because they know it is true.

All your excuses are lies.

STOP LYING TO YOURSELF.

PUT THE DONUT DOWN

PUT IT DOWN.

Step away from the counter.

That's right. Nice and easy. Just back up.

NOW.

You've got some powdered sugar on your fingers—

NO. NO. DO NOT LICK THEM.

Pick up that napkin over there. *Slowly.*

Wipe your fingers off. Good.

Okay. Set the napkin down. Yep. Right there.

Now back away. Back away. Turn around. Good.

Step out the door.

There you go. Keep walking.

There it is. You're safe—for now.

But stay vigilant.

And STAY ON THE PATH.

DOESN'T MATTER

People ask me, "How are you doing?"

And I don't want to cause a scene or make a spectacle out of myself.

So I say something ordinary
and pleasant back to them like,

"Fine,"

"thanks,"

or *"Good,*

thank you."

But the response in my head isn't ordinary and it isn't pleasant. If I were to speak truthfully when people asked me how I was doing, I would tell them: "It doesn't matter how I'm doing."

Because that's the truth.

It doesn't matter if I feel good or bad or excited or bored or happy or sad.

IT DOESN'T MATTER.

I am going to do what I am supposed to do.

DO WHAT MAKES YOU HAPPY

I hear people say this.

And I get it.

In life, do what makes you happy.

Try to find a job that makes you happy.

Try to hang around people that make you happy.

Try to live in a place that makes you happy.

These things are good.

When you view things in your life from a long-term, strategic perspective, then absolutely:

Do what makes you happy.

The problem comes when people decide
to let that ethos drive their daily life.

When people try to do what makes them happy every day. This is wrong.
Do not do it.

Lying in bed for another 37 minutes makes you happy.

Eating a donut will make you happy.

Watching another episode of some random television show will make you
happy.

Scrolling through a social media page
will make you happy.

Buying some shiny new product
will make you happy.

These actions all result in short-term happiness.
The problem is they all also result
in long-term misery.

Do not go down that road.

Do not do what makes you happy.

Do what challenges you.

Do what pushes you.

Do what sets you up for long-term strategic success.

Don't do what makes you happy.

Do what makes you better.

STRATEGIC PLANNING

Having a long-term strategic plan is smart.

A three-year plan.

A five-year plan.

Even a ten-year plan for those
larger goals in the future.

These types of plans are important.

But I also want you to remember
that you don't get any closer
to your goals while you are planning.

You don't get any closer to your goals until you

GET UP AND GET AFTER IT.

On top of your planning, be sure to make actual movement toward your goals every day.

THE COUNT IS ZERO

During BUD/S (Basic Underwater Demolition/SEAL) Training, there is an evolution called "Log PT."

"PT" stands for Physical Training.

"Log" stands for, well, logs. Big, heavy logs that students are forced to carry, press over-head, throw in the air, put down, pick up, hold in the air with extended arms, and do things like squats, push-ups, sit-ups, lunges, and other calisthenics, all while holding these heavy, awkward logs.

The instructors would assign the exercises, the number of repetitions required, and then we students would execute them.

The problem was, if we could not execute the exercises with the proper form or correctly synchronized with the rest of the students, the instructor would announce:

"THE COUNT IS ZERO."

That is right. Regardless of whether we had completed 5 reps of 100 assigned or 95 reps of 100 assigned, we would be sent back to zero and have to start all over again.

This of course was soul-crushing for some of the students—to get so close and then get sent back to square one.

But it is an attitude that can and should be applied to many aspects of life.

It means do not rest on your laurels.
Do not think you have done enough.
It does not matter what you did yesterday.
Yesterday is gone. And today:

THE COUNT IS ZERO.

Wake up with that attitude every day.
You have to prove yourself all over again.
You have to earn your seat at the table.

You have to **GET AFTER IT.**

I FEEL FINE

During SEAL training, there is a lot of scuba diving. Scuba diving has inherent dangers; scuba diving at night, with equipment, over long distances, in and around harbors, ships, and other man-made obstacles only increases those dangers.

In the event of an emergency, we are trained to follow procedures. To proceed to the surface of the water in a certain way. To inflate our life jackets in certain way. To signal for help in a certain way.

And, when you come to the surface after having some kind of diving-related emergency, a medic or diving medical officer will ask you how you are feeling. Only one response is acceptable:

"I FEEL FINE."

The roots of this statement come from the fact that a diver on the surface may have suffered from a diving emergency, which means they might have suffered some level of neurological damage. A quick way to check for immediate signs of this are 1) seeing if they remember to give the proper response, and 2) seeing if they have the physiological agility and fine motor control to properly enunciate the "f's," which take more effort than many other letters.

So, it really didn't matter how you actually felt. You could be freezing cold, exhausted, dehydrated, confused, and mentally broken, but there was still only one answer to the question, "How do you feel?" and that response was:

"I FEEL FINE."

I don't know when this procedure started in the SEAL Teams, but I do know it was in place long before I arrived.

I also know this: The answer "I FEEL FINE" eventually morphed into a response for any time you got asked how you were feeling, regardless of how you actually felt.

Tired?

Worn down?

Starving?

Blisters?

Chaffed?

Hungry?

None of that matters.

The response would still be:

"I FEEL FINE."

And you know what?

When you said those words,
you started to believe them.

And when other people, people in the same state as you, would hear you speak those words, they would think, "Well, I know what he's been through, but he still has a good attitude. I guess I can too."

So don't let yourself get down.

Don't admit it to yourself.

Don't admit it to your friends.

Instead, tell them and *yourself* the only proper response:

"I FEEL FINE."

Problem/Solution.

many people would get overwhelmed and freeze.
Sometimes,
just about everyone would get overwhelmed
and freeze.

And then sometimes, one man would
go on the attack. He would grab a
few other guys, go into a full berserker
mode, and begin to assault the enemy.

While not always successful, the alternative
was to sit still, do nothing, and die.

And more often than not, this aggressive
action would have a positive effect.

It would *disrupt the enemy's plan*.

It would *inspire* other members
of the platoon to get aggressive.

It could even *shift the
momentum of the battle* and the platoon
could get the upper hand and win.

At a minimum, it would change the situation in a positive way,
opening up opportunities and providing an opportunity to shift the
scenario from certain defeat to possible victory.

How does this apply to life?

Life, like combat, can be *overwhelming*.

If that happens, sometimes you have to go on the attack. Fix your
sights on the problem and assault it. **Charge.**

You may not be successful.

But it is better than sitting there

waiting to die.

And you just might turn things around and win.

LEADERSHIP VACUUM

There were also times during advanced SEAL training when the SEALs would get overwhelmed and no one would step up and make things happen. None of the troops. None of the leaders. I would call this a Leadership Vacuum. No one would make a decision. No one would attack. Everything would fall apart.

This can also happen in your head.

Your mind empties.

You don't make any decision.

Whatever happens, happens.

And what happens will be the path of least resistance.

DO NOT ALLOW THAT.

**DO NOT ALLOW A LEADERSHIP VACUUM
IN YOUR HEAD.**

Instead.

Step in.

Step up.

TAKE CHARGE OF YOUR MIND.

And do what you know you should do.

COMFORT AMBUSH

Does the snooze button sneak onto your finger
and deliver an extra 9 minutes of sleep?

Does a donut surreptitiously slip into
your mouth? Do you unconsciously
chew and swallow that sugarcoated lie?

Does comfort clandestinely ambush you on the way to the gym and
prevent you from getting to the gym and doing your workout?

No.

Of course not.

None of these things happen.

Comfort and luxury do not ambush you.

YOU AMBUSH YOURSELF.

YOU ALLOW IT TO HAPPEN.

DO NOT DO THAT.

STAY VIGILANT.

STAY ON THE PATH.

DON'T NEGOTIATE WITH WEAKNESS

There are all kinds of thoughts in your head.

Debates going on.

Discussions.

Rationalizations.

Negotiations.

"I worked out hard yesterday."

"Missing one workout won't matter."

"I can just do this task later."

"One piece of pizza won't make a difference."

"That article said rest and recovery was more important than work."

These are the voices of weakness trying
to negotiate with discipline.

DO NOT NEGOTIATE WITH WEAKNESS.

SHUT THOSE VOICES DOWN.

AND MAKE THEM PAY FOR SPEAKING UP.

MENIAL TASKS

There are things that you have to do
in life that seem meaningless.

Things that are tedious and boring.

Things that have little impact on your
life. But things that need to get done.

Paperwork.

Maintenance.

A trip to the DMV.

Chores. Errands.

Monotonous, mundane tasks.

Because they are wearisome, we don't want to carry out these burdens.

WRONG ANSWER.

If you have things to do, **DO THEM**.

DO THEM HARD.

Don't let them hang over your head.

Get them done.

Line them up and **KNOCK THEM OUT**.

Get those tasks off your plate so you can move on to bigger and
better things.

ACTION YOU

The French philosopher Descartes said:

"I think, therefore I am."

And I get it.

If we are thinking, we must exist.

That's fine.

But never forget:

Thinking alone won't get you anywhere.

Simple existence is not being alive.

You have to take action.

You have to move forward.

You have to exert and strive and toil.

Thoughts are not enough.

TAKE ACTION.

What is it stopping you?

Didn't get enough sleep?

Are you too tired?

Do you not have the right gear?

Do you not have enough energy?

Do you not have enough money?

Do you not have enough time?

Is it one of these things that is stopping you?

Or is the thing that is stopping you,

you?

TIME HAPPINESS

The clock is ticking.

And old Father Time is cruel and unsparing.

Time offers no forgiveness.
It grants pardon to no one.

It has no mercy.

Time is ruthless.

So what should you do?

GET RUTHLESS RIGHT BACK.

Have no mercy on your time.

Don't allow it any slack.

Don't let any slip by.

Grab time by the throat and
get what you want out of it.

Where do you find happiness?

Is it out there somewhere waiting to be discovered?

Under a rock?
Out in the woods?
Buried in the desert?

Where do you find it?

You don't find happiness.
You make it. You put forth effort.
You work for it.
You take on responsibility.
You put yourself out there;
you take risk to achieve a worthy goal.

And in that pursuit, if you pay attention,
if you look around,
you will find

happiness.

SCORCHED EARTH ADD IT UP

It is good to be balanced.
It is good to be measured
in your approach to most things.
It is good to keep your options
open and have alternative plans.
It is good not to burn bridges.

But.
Sometimes you have to go all in.

No plan "B."

No other way out.

No alternatives.

No reserves.

SCORCHED EARTH POLICY.

Leave nothing behind but blood,
sweat, and the charred remains of your enemy.
People think hesitation is a tiny little thing.
They think it is just a fraction of a moment.
They think it is so minuscule that it has no value.

But if you add up all the
hesitation from your life.

If you compile all the missed opportunities.
All the things you wish you would have done
or know you should have done, but didn't.

If you combine all those things together
and put them into a big pile, imagine how big
that pile would be.

Imagine what an accumulation of unrealized potential you would see in
front of you.

Don't allow that.

Don't hesitate.

GO.

INTERNAL THOUGHTS AND DIALOGUE

People sometimes ask me what
I say to myself when things get hard.

What is my internal dialogue?

What do I think about?

The answer is simple.

Nothing.

When things are tough
and I don't feel like going on,
I don't say anything to myself.

I don't think about anything.

In fact: I shut my mind down
and do what I am supposed to do.

Turn off your brain
and let your body function independently.

Your body doesn't need approval from your mind.
It knows what it is supposed to do.

Shut off your mind and let your body do the work.
In the SEAL Teams we had a saying:

Plan your dive. Dive your plan.

When preparing to do a combat swimmer operation, much planning is required. Combat swimmer is the use of scuba equipment to dive undetected into enemy-controlled harbors and ports. That means diving at night over long distances with only a compass to guide you. So you come up with a plan. Once actually diving, people have a tendency to try to make adjustments, to take shortcuts, to modify what they originally planned. This adaptation seldom works out. Hence the mantra:

Plan your dive. Dive your plan.

As much as possible: Stick with what you originally intended to do. Use your detailed understanding of the plan and the rehearsals you conducted to your advantage while underwater. It will grant you the greatest probability for success.

The same goes with your daily life. Come up with a plan and stick to it. I'm not saying to drive a plan into the dirt and fail if it is not working. But for the most part, if possible, execute what you intended to execute. Do what you said you were going to do. Don't let voices or thoughts pull you off track.

Plan your dive. Dive your plan.

LET'S FIND OUT

What would happen if you implemented unmitigated daily discipline in your life?

What would happen if you stopped procrastinating?

What if you lined up tasks and smashed them?

What if you aggressively and unmercifully pursued your goals?

Where would all that end up?

Would you be guaranteed to win?

Is victory assured?

I don't know.

I don't know how it ends up.

I think I know the answer.

And I think you know.

But there is only one way to confirm that answer—and that is by executing those things.

So:

LET'S FIND OUT.



PART 2:

ACTIONS

PHYSICAL TRAINING:
GETTING
AFTER IT

PHYSICAL TRAINING

There are all kinds of benefits from physical training.
You will be healthier.

This is a fact.

By working out, you will increase your endorphins, testosterone, growth hormones, cardiac volume, insulin sensitivity, and natural killer cells.

Those changes will help prevent or treat the following health issues: high blood pressure, obesity, heart disease, type 2 diabetes, insomnia, and depression.

BOOM.

Still not convinced?

Working out will make you smarter. Yes: *Smarter*.

It improves blood flow to the brain.

It boosts growth hormones that promote growth of new nerve cells.

It improves synaptic plasticity, the ability for neurons to send and receive messages.

It releases brain chemicals that help cognition, like: dopamine, glutamate, norepinephrine, and serotonin.

It also boosts the production of brain-derived neurotrophic factor (BDNF), a protein that helps with mental processes.

But, don't just take my word for it.

Go. Do.

Get some exercise done and pay attention to your mental state. You will feel more aware, sharper, and smarter.

THIS IS REAL.

STRESS: GOOD AND BAD

Stress is good and bad.

In order to improve, we need stress. We need to push the body and the mind in order to get better.

One of our main physical reactions to stress is the release of the hormone cortisol into the body. It has a multitude of effects, including making glucose available to the brain, generating energy from stored reserves, and focusing energy on immediate threats rather than less urgent needs. It also raises blood pressure to optimize the flow of blood throughout the body.

But, stress can also be bad. If we are under too much stress, and cortisol is released into the body too often, it begins to have negative effects, like a car running "in the red" for extended periods of time. When cortisol levels remain consistently high, the immune system can become repressed, increasing blood pressure and causing hypertension—a sustained high blood pressure that causes damage to the heart and blood vessels. It can also encourage fat deposits and even cause some level of bone loss.

Exercise is a form of stress and does cause the release of cortisol. However, just as exercise conditions the muscles and the heart, it also conditions the body to react properly to the release of cortisol and trains the body to keep cortisol levels balanced. Excessive regular release of cortisol can also be a significant factor in overtraining—when we push the body too hard, excessive cortisol leads to fatigue and a drop in performance.

So you have to be careful not to stress the body and mind too much. But again: **YOU MUST STRESS THE BODY AND MIND SOME IN ORDER TO IMPROVE.**

WHEN?

The biggest excuse not to work out is lack of time.

Something always comes up.

But there is one time of day that no one can take away from you: predawn.

The military has a term: "Stand To." It means get up early and be ready for enemy attack. It has been a standard practice for many wars. For instance, in World War One, each man was expected to be awake well before first light, standing on the trench fire step, rifle loaded, bayonet fixed, and ready to repel an attack.

Further back in history, from Rogers' Rangers Standing Orders: "All hands shall be awake, alert and ready for action before dawn. Dawn's when the French and Indians like to attack."

So.

Get up before the sun. Be ready to

attack.

Yes, that means

GET UP EARLY!

This will be hard at first, but it will become normal.

And once you are accustomed to it, early rising is guaranteed to make *your day better.*

SO GET AFTER IT.

PSYCHOLOGICAL EDGE

There are a slew of psychological advantages that come from early morning physical training.

First, there is a psychological win over the enemy. Knowing that you are working harder than your adversaries gives you an advantage. It gives you confidence that you can overcome them in battle.

Another advantage to waking up early and working out hard is that it demands discipline to do both. Now, some scientists have claimed that discipline dissipates the more it is used—that willpower is a finite resource that is reduced every time it is used during the day.

This is wrong. That does *not happen*.

To the contrary, I believe, and studies have shown, that discipline and willpower do not go down as they are called into action—they actually get stronger.

This is obvious if you actually try the experiment yourself:

Before you go to bed, plan what workout you are going to do in the morning. Stage your workout clothes so you don't even have to think when you get up. Write down a list of things you need to accomplish the next day. Set your alarm clock for 4:30 a.m. and go to sleep.

When the alarm clock goes off—get up. Put on your pre-staged clothes. Brush your teeth and go get your workout on. Hard. Get done, shower, get dressed, and begin to crush your list of tasks for the day.

When it is time for breakfast, see what happens. You won't want to eat junk. You won't want that disgusting donut. You will want some eggs and bacon. And that will happen at lunch too. You are feeling good. Energized. You don't want to eat the worthless calories of pizza or French fries. You want fuel. Good fuel to rebuild your body. Clean fuel that keeps your mind sharp. When you are on the path you want to stay on the path.

Unfortunately, the opposite is also true. Once you step off the path, you tend to stray far. When you don't prepare what you need to do the next day, when you sleep in and then skip your workout and you don't start attacking the tasks you have—because you didn't write them down the night before—that is when you make bad decisions. That is when your will and discipline fail. You figure you might as well have that donut for breakfast and once you have done that, might as well put down four or five pieces of pizza for lunch. *It doesn't matter*

anymore—you're off the path and that is a disaster. Your will didn't break—it never showed up in the first place.

So. Get on the path of discipline and stay on the path.

Discipline begets discipline.

Will propagates **MORE WILL**.

Hold the line across the line and victory will be yours.

SLEEP

Sleep is a necessity. Humans need sleep. Failure to get enough sleep has serious side effects. Lack of sleep can cause negative hormonal changes, interfere with the metabolizing of glucose, increase blood pressure, and suppress the immune system. Less sleep also means less human growth hormone in your body, which means less muscle mass and weaker bones. Mentally, the brain is impacted as the ability to pay attention and concentrate begins to diminish and problem solving and basic reasoning become less acute. Furthermore, over an extended period, there are psychological effects like paranoia and even hallucinations.

But how much sleep is enough? Different people need different amounts of sleep. Newborns can sleep up to seventeen hours a day; toddlers can sleep up to twelve hours a day. As people grow older, less sleep is required. Teens generally need eight to ten hours and by the time people are full adults eight hours becomes the standard—though the actual number is between seven and nine hours, depending on the individual. Some people genetically need even less sleep than that, but those people are rare. I am one of those people.

But it isn't only genetics.

You can also sleep less and fall asleep faster if you are in good physical condition, eating clean, and have a clear mind.

For me, the better the condition I'm in and the cleaner I eat, the more quickly I will fall asleep, and the less sleep I need.

So, while I do have short-sleep genetics on my side, equally important is that I stay healthy and eat clean.

And finally, I choose not to sleep in.

I don't give in to the temptation of the warm blankets and soft pillow.

I mobilize the will to get me out of
bed and into the game.

Obviously, I am an advocate of waking up early.

But, since sleep must be a priority to maintain health, how can we get enough sleep and still wake up early? The answer is simple:

Go to bed earlier.

Going to bed at 10 p.m. and waking up at 5 a.m. gets you a solid seven hours.

Go to bed at 9:55 p.m. and you can get up at 4:55 a.m., still get your seven hours, and be up before the enemy.

Try it. If you get up and get out of bed at 4:55, a vast majority of the world is still sleeping.

You aren't.

You are up getting after it.

The world is yours when you are up before the enemy.

There is no traffic. The gym is empty. There is no one to distract you or call you or send you some stupid text about something you don't care about.

It's just you.

So, go to bed early, and wake up early.

People constantly ask me for the secret of getting up early.

I tell them it is simple:

SET YOUR ALARM CLOCK AND GET OUT OF BED WHEN IT GOES OFF.

That's it.

Is it easy? No.

Everyone likes that warm bed.

Everyone needs just five more minutes of slumber in the morning.

So they hit snooze. They roll over. They go back to sleep.

No.

Get up and get going. And one thing that will help you do that is going to bed earlier, which can be at least as hard, if not harder, than waking up.

FALLING ASLEEP

Yes. It can be just as hard for some people to go to sleep early as it is to wake up—if not harder.

So here are some steps to help that:

1. GET TIRED. Yes, get tired. If you are not active throughout the day, you won't be tired. Getting a hard workout in the early morning will not only energize you during the day but will also make you fall asleep faster at night. Getting a morning workout and another workout at lunch or after work will also get you tired. Unfortunately, you may find that working out just prior to going to bed will keep you awake, so try not to work out any closer than two hours before you want to sleep.

2. Turn off the computer. Turn off the smartphone. Stop checking social media and stop watching *one more* YouTube video. Sure, there is some science that says that the light from computer and phone screens tricks your mind into thinking it is daylight and time to get up. But on top of that, the internet is filled with professionals that create content with the sole purpose of getting you to click on it. Yes, clickbait is real, and just like a bait used in fishing, it is a trick to get you hooked. So: Don't. Don't click it. You will get nothing positive from it. **AT ALL.**

3. Read. If your mind is still active when you reach your bedtime—that's okay. Get into bed and get a book and start reading. Reading is relaxing. It settles your mind. And it makes you smarter. So do it. And if the book you are reading is *too good* and makes you want to stay up and read—simple—don't read that book. Read a boring one—an educational one—but a boring one. That will send you to sleep.

4. Most important: The key to getting to sleep early is GETTING UP EARLY. No, it might not help you *tonight* but tomorrow night it will. If you need seven full hours of sleep, and you want to get up at 4:30 a.m., that means you need to go to bed at 9:30 p.m. But it can be hard to force yourself to sleep at 9:30. So. You stay up until 11:30. You should STILL GET UP AT 4:30. Yes, that will be only five hours of sleep. And yes, you will likely feel tired through the day—which is actually good, because at the end of the day, you WANT TO BE TIRED. Now, you can go to bed at 9:30—you are now on track.

5. Do it every day. People ask me if I still get up early on the weekends. YES. For a bunch of reasons. Obviously, the weekend is only two days so I want to get up and take advantage of it. I get up early, get my workout done, and complete any must-do tasks as quickly as possible. That allows for time to relax and enjoy without things hanging over your head. The other reason I wake up early on weekends is to keep my sleep pattern consistent. If I sleep in to 5:30 or 6 a.m. on Saturday, I will likely stay awake a couple of extra hours on Saturday night, which now has me sleeping in until 7 a.m. on Sunday, which now has me awake even later on Sunday night—which means when I go back to waking up at 4:30 on Monday, I haven't gotten the sleep I need. So: Don't break the cycle. Get up early every day. If you need extra sleep, take a power nap.

POWER NAPS

Power naps. They are real. If you are feeling tired they can be a lifesaver. And if you are feeling tired due to lack of sleep, they can be very powerful. I have a technique for power naps that is a combination of two things I learned.

The first was in high school. My anatomy and physiology teacher was a high-energy, passionate teacher. But if you went into his classroom during lunch, you would find him sitting in a chair with his feet elevated on the lab tables, sleeping. He did it just about every day. One day I asked him about it; he said his goal was to elevate his feet above his heart and sleep for ten to fifteen minutes before he ate his lunch. He said the nap gave him energy. Elevating his feet above his heart took the strain off the circulatory system in his lower body and helped move some of the blood that might have pooled in his feet and legs. I began to try it occasionally and it certainly felt good.

But I really noticed it when I got to BUD/S, the basic SEAL training course. Obviously, we were operating in a fairly sleep-deprived environment there on an almost daily basis and the schedule was very tight, going from evolution to evolution throughout the day, on a strict timeline. But there were some holes in the schedule, usually ten to fifteen minutes a couple of times a day for us to prepare for our next evolution and use the bathroom. During those breaks, if I got the chance, I would lie down on the floor, put my feet up on my bed, set my alarm for six to eight minutes, and sleep. Of course, I was tired, so I would fall asleep very quickly, and when the alarm would go off, I would wake up and feel completely refreshed. It was awesome.

When I got to the SEAL Teams, I used the same technique and found it especially helpful during long patrols in the field. When we formed a perimeter for a break and I wasn't on security, I would immediately elevate my feet and take a power nap. The effects were even more obvious, since on a patrol we were on our feet for many hours carrying a heavy load.

I still use this effective technique when I am overly tired.

Warning: Be careful about letting your six- to eight-minute nap turn into a two-hour slumber. If you do this, you will have trouble falling asleep at night, which leads to trouble waking up in the

morning. That means there is a higher chance you will fall off the early morning schedule.

THE WORKOUTS

Everyone wants to know: What should a workout actually consist of?

And first of all—let me say this: The most important thing to do is

SOMETHING.

ANYTHING.

Walk. Jog. Calisthenics. Swim. Lift some weights. Hike. Stretch. Do burpees. Play a game of basketball or go get on the jiu-jitsu mat. Some people aren't sure what to do for a workout—but that is often just an excuse.

Exercise doesn't need to be some complex, multi-level, multi-dimensional, scientifically proven methodology. But it does need to be SOMETHING.

Once you begin doing something, it is a good idea to track it. Recording weights, repetitions, and times is useful. The records allow you to track progress. They can serve as goals. They also let you know when you are overtraining. But, it is important to pay attention to your state at the end of a workout. The more experienced you become at working out, the easier this is. You will know when to push. You will know that there are days to hold back.

My workouts are divided into some broad types of movements: Pull, Push, Lift, Squat. In addition to those, the workouts focus working the "Gut" and metabolic conditioning (MetCon).

For the purposes of this field manual, I have established three basic levels of exercises: Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced.

This is only a guide. As you become stronger, more experienced, and more in tune with your body and your desired outcomes, make adjustments. Read and learn. Try new systems. Learn new exercises. Try new movements and new sports. Mix it up and have fun. Push yourself, but do so in a measured way so you avoid burnout, overtraining, and injury.

To see the actual workouts, go to

Appendix: The Workouts

Again, use the workouts as a guide. Learn about your own body. Push yourself. Most important: Be consistent. And consistency starts with GETTING IN THE GYM. If you are tired or sore or burned out, don't just give up completely. Go to the gym and stretch. Move. Do some light exercises. But keep the routine in place.

Too often, people take the day off. And that turns into two. And two into three. And then they have gone a week without getting in a good workout.

SO.

Maintain the routine.

Maintain the discipline.

BUILDING THE HOME GYM

Having a gym in your home eliminates all kinds of excuses. There is nothing more convenient than having your gym collocated with your domicile. I have had a garage gym since I have had a garage. But garage gyms don't need to be in a garage—they can go anywhere: basements, spare bedrooms, offices, backyards, front yards, patios, car-ports...anywhere. Just like anything else in life, you do what you can with what you've got.

Once you have carved out some space, it is time to start getting equipment in place. Start with a pull-up bar. You can mount one just about anywhere and once you have a pull-up bar, you can work your whole body with all the varieties of pull-ups, push-ups, gut work, and squats.

Another useful and relatively cheap piece of equipment is gymnastic rings. They can also be mounted just about anywhere and allow a great number of exercises, including: ring dips, ring pull-ups, ring push-ups, L-sits, all kinds of various holds, and countless variants of each of those.

Next up is a squat rack, which should include a pull-up bar and some kind of dip bar attachment. With the squat rack, a barbell and weights are needed. Rubber bumper plates allow for dynamic lifts like the clean and jerk and the snatch.

That's it. That's all you need.

That basic setup should go a long way in achieving exceptional fitness. Beyond that there are countless implements to include in your arsenal when time and budget allow. Kettlebells are probably the next addition, then a rowing machine and/or an air bike. A Glute-Ham Developer (GHD) is another piece of equipment that is definitely nice to have at home. Medicine balls, plyometric boxes, bands, chains, club bells, sledgehammers are also fun to use. But, while all those pieces of equipment are nice to have and can add some variety to training, none of them are really necessary, and although I have all those in my gym, I still most consistently use the basic equipment: pull-up bar, dip bars, rings, squat rack, and barbell with bumper plates.

MARTIAL ARTS

Everyone should train in martial arts, just as everyone should eat.

But just as food is different and varies greatly in how it affects your body, not all martial arts are created equal.

There are three broad forms of martial arts: **grappling, striking, and weapons.**

Grappling uses leverage and holds to control or submit your opponent. Striking uses punches, kicks, knees, elbows, headbutts, and any other body parts to hit the opponent. Martial arts with weapons obviously utilize a variety of weapons, including sticks, knives, and, in the modern world, firearms.

Perhaps the most critical form of self-defense is the mind. By being smart and aware, you can avoid situations that are likely to expose you to danger. That being said, there are times when your mind and your intelligence can no longer help you. That is the reality. In those cases, the ultimate form of self-defense is obviously the firearm. It is an equalizer without parallel and is simply unmatched in its ability to eliminate an attacker regardless of size and strength. If a person truly needs self-protection in a high-threat area, there is no substitute for the firearm. Even in an area that might be considered low-threat, there are no guarantees. There have been horrific home invasions, carjackings, kidnappings, and other vicious and violent attacks in some of the most prestigious neighborhoods in the world that were also considered to be the safest. There is no choice but to be prepared.

Of course, mishandled firearms are extremely dangerous and can cause serious injury and death to the owner or other innocent people if they are

not handled with the four principles of firearm safety constantly in mind:

1. **Treat every gun as if it is loaded.**
2. **Never point your gun at something you are not willing to destroy.**
3. **Keep your finger off the trigger until your sights are on target.**
4. **Always be sure of your target and what is behind it.**

Additionally, firearms should always be stored in a safe place where they cannot fall into the wrong hands.

Most important, without proper training, possessing a firearm is useless, or even more dangerous to its owner than not having one. Learning how to shoot quickly and accurately while under stress is absolutely mandatory if one is going to own a firearm. This means finding a good instructor at a quality range to participate in firearms training.

Safety is paramount in firearms training. When treated properly and with respect, firearms training is safe. Not only does it prepare you for worst-case-scenario confrontations, but also provides additional benefits even if you never need to utilize your firearm for self-protection.

Firearms training builds hand-eye coordination, speed, concentration, and instincts. It demands repetitive movement to develop muscle memory and demands a high level of proprioception when shooting in a dynamic situation. Finally, training competitively for speed and accuracy conditions you for high-pressure situations by teaching the need to relax, detach, get control of breathing, and focus on the immediate task at hand.

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But firearms are not always available. There are many places in the world where carrying a gun is illegal. There are also times where firearms malfunction. So it is important to know how to defend yourself in unarmed situations, which brings us back to martial arts.

First let me say that the martial arts are very emotional for some people. Their martial art becomes their religion and they become blinded by it. Martial arts are not static. They evolve all the time. If you do not evolve with them, you will be left behind. Picking one martial art versus another or saying that one martial art is "better" than another martial art drives some people crazy. I do not engage in irrational theoretical discussions on which martial art is best. There is no reason to theorize anymore.

The Ultimate Fighting Championship (UFC) put many theories to the test. The wars in Iraq and Afghanistan also put many theories about hand-to-hand combat to the test. Finally, every person now carries a video camera in their pocket and there are thousands of street fights and confrontations to watch on the internet.

With all that information readily available, there is no need to theorize anymore. It is easy to see what works and what doesn't. Furthermore, it is also obvious that martial arts are not stagnant. They evolve. People develop new techniques and new moves to counter

other techniques and other moves. But the fundamental principles do not change—they only become reinforced.

With all this information available and with so many theories now tested in the cage, on the street, and in combat, martial arts are no longer just a theory. There is simple, pragmatic reality.

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So, here are my recommendations on which martial arts to learn and how to proceed down the path of learning martial arts.

Start with Brazilian jiu-jitsu. It is a form of grappling that is highly advanced because, for the most part, the actual fighting takes place on the ground. This is a key point, because our first form of self-defense is to get away—yes, run. If you are confronted by another person or a group of people, the best thing you can do is run away: avoid the conflict. This is relatively easy if someone is trying to strike you with punches or kicks. They do not have control over you, so you can simply run away from them. You have won.

The problem comes in a self-defense situation when someone is grabbing you. Now they are preventing your first line of defense: Running away. As soon as someone grabs you, you are in a grappling scenario, and one of the most critical parts of Brazilian jiu-jitsu is escaping from someone's grip so you can run.

Oftentimes, an attacker will take you to the ground in order to prevent you from escaping their grip. When this happens, the ability to ground fight is used not to stay on the ground but to get up and get away from the attacker. The first goal of a beginner in jiu-jitsu is not to get the fight to the ground, but to get up off the ground and get away. This is an important distinction from people who believe the goal of self-defense in jiu-jitsu is to get the attacker to the ground. This is not true. The goal is to get away. But, as has been seen over and over again, fights often end up on the ground, and therefore a person must be prepared for it. Not training in jiu-jitsu because you don't want to go to the ground is like not learning to swim because you don't want to go in the water. It doesn't make sense. The safest way to deal with water is to be comfortable in it—just as being comfortable on the ground is the best way to deal with that scenario, should it unfold in real life.

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Another reason I recommend starting martial arts by learning Brazilian jiu-jitsu is because it is the most complex of the martial arts. Although there is a finite number of basic moves and positions, there is an infinite number of moves beyond the basics, and more are developed every day in this constantly evolving art. Due to this

unending depth in jiu-jitsu, it is also the most cerebral of the martial arts. It provides incredible mental stimulus and a never-ending challenge to learn, develop, and improve. Jiu-jitsu never gets old.

The next martial art I recommend learning is boxing. Boxing is an incredibly effective striking art despite its relative simplicity: There are only two weapons in boxing—the left hand and the right hand. But with those two weapons, an incredible advantage can be gained if you know how to throw them in effective combinations. Other critical elements learned in boxing are angles, movement (both of which are based heavily on footwork), and speed, which are utilized in both the offense and defense of boxing. With basic boxing knowledge, a person can throw effective punches and avoid being punched—both extremely useful assets when attempting the primary goal of self-defense: Run. Boxing develops the ability to hit quickly, avoid being hit, and run away from the area of confrontation.

The next two martial arts to invest time into are Muay Thai and wrestling. They both add a plethora of options and skills to any fighter.

Muay Thai adds a massive arsenal of striking options to a fighter. Where boxing utilizes only the fists, Muay Thai utilizes the fists, the elbows, the knees, and the shins in very aggressive combinations that are absolutely devastating in a fight. Muay Thai is also about pain and the ability to withstand pain.

The conditioning of the shins to kick and shield kicks, as well as the conditioning of the body and legs to absorb punishment, is brutal and requires an iron will. Muay Thai also offers great work in striking from the clinch position, when an opponent is grabbing you by the head and/or arms. The strikes from this close range, especially the knees and elbows, are vicious. Techniques are also taught to trip or sweep the opponent to the ground that are powerful and effective.

Wrestling is a grappling art, perhaps the most widely known and practiced. It is an amazing sport for conditioning of both the mind and the body. The physical grind of wrestling hardens the body and mind without mercy. On top of the conditioning and mental toughness derived from wrestling, it is also king of position in martial arts—meaning a good wrestler can decide what position they will be in during a confrontation. No other martial art provides the practitioner a better ability to dictate the position of a fight with one simple idea: The main focus of wrestling is to get an opponent to the ground and keep them there. This means wrestling increases the ability not only to take an adversary to the ground and keep them there, but also the ability to defend yourself from being taken to

the ground. So, if you are more skilled in wrestling than your opponent, you can dictate where you fight. If you are a better striker than your opponent, you can defend their takedown and win the fight on your feet. If your opponent is a better striker, you can take them to the ground and defeat them with superior grappling. Unfortunately, submission holds do not exist in wrestling, so there are no techniques taught on how to actually finish fights. That being said, there are some practitioners of what is known as "catch wrestling" who continue to teach extremely effective submission holds that were outlawed by the sport as wrestling gained popularity.

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Once a good base is established in Brazilian jiu-jitsu, boxing, wrestling, and Muay Thai, there are plenty of other martial arts to explore. Judo is a fantastic art and has very effective takedowns, especially against an opponent wearing a jacket or shirt that can be grabbed, which is often the case. Once on the ground, judo has many similarities with Brazilian jiu-jitsu and many of the same techniques are taught. In areas where there might not be any Brazilian jiu-jitsu schools, judo is the next best replacement. The Russian art of SAMBO is also an extremely effective grappling art with an emphasis on leg locks.

There are other martial arts that can be good to look into such as Krav Maga and Systema, both of which focus on self-defense as its primary mission. Martial arts like Escrima and Kali from the Philippines, also known as Arnis, which focus on fighting with sticks and knives. Also, the Dog Brothers have pushed the limit in full-contact weapons sparring—and in that effort have garnered real-world knowledge beyond what was previously available.

The list could go on and on. There is no reason to ever stop training and learning martial arts. Of course, it is good to be prepared to handle a self-defense situation, but the benefits of martial arts training go far beyond self-defense.

Of course, you get physically conditioned. You also get mentally tougher—real martial arts are hard. They are a mental and physical grind. If the martial art you are training in is easy, it isn't likely doing you much good. Martial arts also get you used to being in uncomfortable situations and continuing to fight on. This is important in any endeavor. Martial arts will make you better.

So train. Don't think about it. Don't take time to "get in shape" before you start. Just go start. The rest will come...

WHERE TO TRAIN

When picking a good jiu-jitsu academy, first things first: Find some schools that are in your immediate area. Proximity is important. The more convenient it is to get to training, the more often you will be able to train. So find some schools that are close to your home or work or some other place where it isn't an out-of-your-way gut check to show up and train.

Once you have identified some academies close by, go and pay a visit. The atmospheres in gyms can vary greatly. Some are very traditional, demand matching uniforms, bowing to instructors and to the mat, and are run in a very rigid manner. Other schools do not operate with that tradition. There is no bowing. A wide variety of uniforms can be seen on the mat. Instructors are called by their first names instead of "Master," or "Sensei," or "Professor." I have trained in both these types of schools, I am fine with both, and both types have produced world champions. You may end up preferring one style or another, but when you show up, don't have any preconceived ideas of what the school will be like.

Also, don't just show up and watch. Bring your gear and participate. Evaluate the class. How was it taught? What was the attitude of the instructor and the other students? Talk to the students. What are their goals? Are their goals similar to yours? Was there much ego on the mat? Did anyone try to rip your head off?

What about the instructor? Depending on where you live the instructor may or may not be a black belt. While a black belt instructor is optimal, some areas of the world just don't have any. That's okay. A brown belt or a purple belt can give great instruction as well. There can be some concern about the legitimacy of the lineage of the instructor as well. Luckily, the internet has solved most of that. A quick internet search can tell you more about the instructor, where they got their black belt, what competitions they have won, and how long they have been training. Do some research and even ask some knowledgeable people in the area or on the web. Once you are confident the instructor is legit, assess their personality. Was he or she personable? Did they teach clearly and methodically? Were they having fun?

Also, with regard to the instructor, remember jiu-jitsu is not a religion and a jiu-jitsu instructor is not a god. So, while they deserve respect, just as any other person does, they should give

respect as well—even to brand-new white belt students. Jiu-jitsu should not feel like a cult—at all.

Bottom line, jiu-jitsu should be fun, friendly, and engaging. You should look forward to going to jiu-jitsu because you know you will get pushed mentally and physically. While jiu-jitsu will absolutely be humbling, tiring, and frustrating, if you don't enjoy it, you are either letting your ego get in the way, or you are in the wrong school.

IMMEDIATE FACING A THREAT ACTION DRILLS:

Obviously, training is the best way to prepare to face threats. But there is a difference between a training scenario at the gym or at the range and a real confrontation on the street.

How can you be ready for that? And how should you react? The first thing to do is train. Train hard. Train for worst-case scenarios. Train for things to go wrong by putting yourself in horrible training situations and finding your way out of them. The next most important concept is avoidance. Yes. Avoid the danger. Stay away from high-threat areas.

But we can't always avoid high-threat areas—and sometimes the high-threat area doesn't avoid us. In the world today, conflict and danger can occur anytime and anywhere. So it is important to maintain situational awareness at all times. Pay attention to your surroundings. Look at suspicious people. Look at unsuspicious people. What are they doing? Where are they going? What are they looking at? Assess.

While you assess, think of contingencies. Where is your closest escape route? Where is the closest cover and concealment—"cover" being a place to shield you from bullets and "concealment" being a place to hide.

If you are maintaining situational awareness, you should be very hard to surprise. If you sense something is going wrong or you sense a threat, proactively move away from it. Walk to the other side of the street. Accelerate your car. Walk out the door. Don't wait for things to get worse.

If you do get surprised and you are caught in a bad situation: **ACT.**

If you can run away from an assailant, do it. If you can't run because they have a hold on you, attack them. Put all your training to use as quickly and as violently as possible. As soon as you can break free, do it and run.

If shooting starts, get down. Call the police at the first opportunity. If the shooting is single shots being fired at a slower

pace, run immediately and keep running. If the shooting is rapid-fire, find some solid cover to get behind. Wait for a lull. When the lull comes, run—that may be your only chance.

If you are trapped in a room with an active shooter outside, barricade yourself. If there is an ideal hiding place, hide. If not, prepare to attack them as soon as they enter the room. Get anyone in the room with you on board and ready to swarm the attacker.

If you are carrying a firearm, use it to eliminate any immediate threat to your life or the life of someone else.

USE EXTREME CAUTION WHEN USING A FIREARM IN ANY SITUATION: KNOW YOUR TARGET. KNOW THE BACKDROP. And, recognize that you might not know who is a good guy and who is a bad guy. The police might also see you as the threat. Some police officers might be in plain clothes. So if you confidently know your target and have to use your weapon, do it quickly and efficiently. Then put it away and do your best to identify yourself as a friendly.



FUEL :

FEEDING THE MACHINE

BALANCE

Homeostasis is the tendency to move toward a state of balance. For instance, in a house, the thermostat keeps the temperature in balance. In the summer it turns on the air conditioner when it gets too hot, and in the winter it turns on the heat when it gets too cold. Homeostasis is being maintained.

- The body also tries to maintain a state of balance in many ways. Like the house, the body maintains a balanced temperature by shivering to heat or sweating to cool.
- Osmoregulation is the regulation of water content in the body. In order to maintain balance, the body uses thirst to increase water levels and sweat and urine to expel excess water.
- The body also uses systems to maintain the balance of acidity, blood pressure, sodium and potassium concentrations in the blood, and plasma ionized calcium. Failure to maintain the proper balance in these systems can cause significant health problems.

There is another balance our bodies maintain that we have a huge influence over. It is our blood glucose level, what we commonly call our blood sugar level. We can directly influence our blood sugar levels by what we eat. When we eat carbohydrates, our blood sugar levels go up. When we eat a lot of carbohydrates, our blood sugar levels go up a lot. The primary action our bodies take to regulate high blood sugar levels is to release the hormone insulin into our blood from the pancreas. Once released, insulin pushes the sugar in the blood into fat cells and also slows down the process of fat in the fat cells being pulled out and used for energy. Obviously, when your body is putting fat into fat cells and not using your fat for energy, you get fatter.

In order to use the fat in your body for energy, the body must have gone through its most readily available source of energy: glucose or sugar in the blood. Once that is depleted, the body begins to utilize fat for energy. You can deplete that sugar in the blood by exercising until it is gone, fasting until it is gone, or adjusting your carbohydrate intake.

There are other extremely negative effects of continued elevated insulin levels in the blood beyond gaining or maintaining body fat. Consistent spiking of insulin in the blood can lead to insulin resistance, which can eventually lead to type 2 diabetes. Other long-term impacts that prolonged elevated insulin levels can cause are

heart disease, diabetic retinopathy (blindness), strokes, and kidney failure. Not good.

So, the solution seems obvious: Stop eating carbohydrates— or at least minimize carbohydrate intake.

Why is that so hard? The answer is simple: Carbohydrates are addictive. Yes, sugar is like a drug in your brain and causes neurochemical responses similar to drugs like heroin.

ADDICTED TO SUGAR

Sugar truly is addictive. It stimulates the same parts of the brain as heroin and cocaine. When you have it you want more of it.

And you know this to be true.

That's why you can't stop eating it.

And when you do stop eating it, you will feel
withdrawal.

Headache.

Irritation.

Anxiety.

Lies.

The lies will come, and they will come from **you**.

The lies you will tell yourself are:

It's no big deal.

You can just have a little.

It isn't worth it to feel *this* bad.

The body *needs* carbs.

You will rationalize and start to listen to the lies.

DON' T.

Stay strong.

Get off the sugar train.

Get off the addiction.

Stop eating sugar.

FUEL

The modern diet has been around for about 10,000 years. That is when man figured out how to plant some foods, grow them, harvest them, make them easier to digest, and store them. These foods were grains: Wheat, rice, corn. Our bodies have not adapted to eating grains yet. When we eat grains, they are turned to sugar in our stomachs. The insulin level spikes and punishes our bodies internally. So, it is better to eat what we have evolved to eat—that is the diet of Paleolithic man or caveman. Here is what that diet consists of:

Eat these:

- Beef (preferably grass-fed)
- Poultry (preferably free-range)
- Fish
- Eggs
- Nuts
- Vegetables
- Fungi
- Roots
- Some dairy (full-fat butter, cream, yogurt, cheese)
- Limited fruit

Do not eat these:

- Grains
- Potatoes
- Refined salt
- Refined sugar
- Processed oils (margarine)
- Legumes

Eating a paleo or caveman diet flips the Standard American Diet on its head from a macronutrient perspective. Instead of eating mostly carbohydrates with minimum fat, this diet consists of mostly fat, then protein, and finally minimal carbohydrates.

Some people use the 80/20 rule, meaning they stick with “clean” paleo eating 80% of the time and then the other 20% of the time they eat whatever they want. The problem is that the 80/20 becomes 60/40, then 40/60, then 20/80 and then all bets are off.

Don't follow the 80/20 rule. Follow the 100% rule—that might turn into the 99% rule and that is okay. But the 80/20 rule isn't a rule. It's a step down the slippery slope.

We know sugar is addictive. You are an addict. There is no such thing as an addict who is allowed to use their drug of choice 20% of the time, whether it is alcohol or cocaine or heroin.

You are in the same boat. Going cold turkey and **HOLDING THE LINE** is the best way to stay on track.

Once you have spent enough time staying 100% clean and you are adapted to that method of eating both mentally and physically, you can make some excursions to the dark side. I have an occasional mint chocolate chip milkshake or some other delicious but not nutritious treat.

And I make sure I earn it beforehand with some serious, extreme physical activity.

Over time, you will realize that you have lost your sweet tooth. You will also realize that the aftereffects, the sugar rush, the sugar crash, and the lack of energy the next day, make the excursions to the dark side highly undesirable and will encourage you to **STAY CLEAN**.

I have some treats that make it easier to stay clean. I eat a couple squares of 80%+ dark chocolate dipped in coconut oil. I have a small glass of full cream with a little MCT oil and a dash of chocolate milk powder. Sometimes I'll have whipped cream with nuts on it. If you are on a strict diet, each one of those treats will taste like the richest most satisfying dessert you have ever had.

Now, there are times during travel and work and life when the right foods simply are not available. In an airport or an office party or a restaurant where you are having a business meeting. My solution to that is very simple: Don't eat. It's called a fast, and it is actually very good for you.

FASTING

Newsflash: **YOU DON'T HAVE TO EAT.**

Fasting is a gift. All those times you are at a party or the airport or on a train and they don't have any good, healthy food for you to eat, the answer is simple:

DON'T EAT.

Often, not eating—fasting—is beneficial for you. Here are some of the physiological benefits that fasting appears to bring:

- Improves function of cells, genes, and hormones
- Induces loss of body fat
- Reduces risk of insulin resistance and type 2 diabetes
- Reduces oxidative stress and inflammation
- Induces cell repair processes
- Increases brain-derived neurotrophic factors
- Increases levels of endorphins
- Induces detoxification process

There are also some psychological benefits that I find very real. First of all, fasting demands that you exercise your will.

It is not easy.

In this modern age, we are surrounded by food all day every day. Your caveman survival instinct, which is afraid of starving, screams at you:

"Eat that food! Eat as much as you can!
This might be your last chance!"

DON'T FALL FOR THAT.

This isn't the last food you will ever see.

In fact: You will see more food in about ten minutes.

You don't need it.

You won't die without it.

In fact: Just the opposite is true.

In this age, much of the food around is actually trying to kill you.

It is poison.

Donuts? Poison. Soda? Poison.

Potato chips? Poison.

YOU DON'T NEED IT.

Another huge benefit of fasting is that it recalibrates your hunger demand signals. We often think we are starving after a few hours without food.

"I haven't had anything to eat since breakfast," we shout at 1:15 in the afternoon. We literally say: "I'm starving!"

YOU ARE NOT STARVING.

Humans can survive thirty days without food.

You can make it a few extra hours.

You can actually make it a few days without any issue.

I fast twenty-four hours fairly regularly.

I do seventy-two-hour fasts approximately every three months.

And you know what, they aren't that big of a deal. When I am fasting, I still do everything I would normally do if I were eating. I work. Work out. Train jiu-jitsu.

I drink water, some tea, maybe eat some sunflower seeds in the shell just to have something to chew on. But fasting isn't that hard and you will feel better at the end of it. Fasting will recalibrate what hunger is to you. You will realize that you aren't actually hungry most of the time. You are just bored. And, at the end of a fast, your food will taste better, too.



REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE:

INJURY PREVENTION AND RECOVERY

STRETCHING

Stretching is an important part of being physically fit. It improves range of motion, helps in recovery, and also prevents injuries. There are a multitude of stretching routines out there from ancient forms of yoga to present-day innovations from people like Pavel Tsatsouline and programs like Kelly Starrett's MobilityWOD. Explore those and find the stretches that work best for you. Some basic stretches that I find most useful are: kneeling hip flexor stretch, swimmer stretch, Cossack stretch, hip external rotation stretch, reverse sleeper stretch, couch stretch, downward dog, and the cow face pose.

You can also stretch during your warm-ups and your workouts by ensuring that you use a full range of motion during the exercises, especially during warm-up sets when doing slow repetitions. For instance, when doing a slow squat during warm-up, make sure it is not only slow but also makes it through the entire range of motion of the squat, perhaps even a little further than you might go when performing the exercise with weight. The same thing goes for exercises like dips, push-ups, and pull-ups: When warming up, go slow and go through the entire range of motion, even pushing a little bit past normal at the top and bottom of the exercise.

Like anything else in health and fitness, stretching requires consistency, so figure out what movements are most beneficial for you. Don't pick too many—stretching can be done in as little as ten to fifteen minutes. But it needs to be done, so make it part of your routine.

Then: Stick to your routine.

DEALING WITH INJURIES AND ILLNESS

You are going to get injured.

You are going to get sick.

Regardless of how careful you are in your training, how clean you eat, and how healthy you live, you are still human.

Injuries and illness will occur.

My theory for overcoming injuries and illnesses is simple:

DO WHAT YOU CAN.

If you are sick or injured, don't use that as an excuse to skip workouts or stay in bed all day.

Do what you can.

Hurt your knee? Work your upper body. Work the good leg. Hurt your shoulder? Time to work on one-armed pull-ups and push-ups. Focus on your core and legs until your shoulder heals up.

Tendinitis from using the grip too much? Sounds like it is time to focus on sprinting and jumping plyometrics.

Got a little cold? Flu? Same thing: **DO WHAT YOU CAN**. Maybe it is just going for a walk. A couple sets of sit-ups and push-ups. But don't just stay in bed all day.

Now, sometimes, you get plain knocked out by illness or a virus. If it is that bad and your body absolutely needs rest, good, listen to your body and **TAKE THE REST**. Also, don't bring your disease to the gym to spread around. Work out at home.

Same thing with injuries. Some injuries prevent you from doing the physical things you like to do. Good. Do what you can, work on some skills that you can do. Pick up a guitar. Write a book. Draw. Paint. Compose a song. Blog. Create. Learn. Do *something*.

Take advantage of physical injuries and sickness by doing something you don't normally have time for. In other words: GET AFTER IT.



APPENDIX:

THE WORKOUTS

WARMING UP

Before you start your workout, you need to get warm.

I like my warm-up to include exercises or exercises with light weight slowly and through the entire range of motion. Here is a nice little warm-up:

Hang on the pull-up bar for 10-15 seconds. Get in the push-up position and hold it for 10-15 seconds. Drop your hips to the ground and stretch your abs. Lift your hips to the sky and stretch your hamstrings and your back. Stand up. Do a slow squat and sit at the bottom for 10-15 seconds. Do a burpee. Do a few jumping jacks.

Now go back to the bar and do one pull-up. Drop down and do a push-up, then do a slow dive-bomber push-up. Stand up and do a slow, full-range-of-motion squat. Follow that up with a burpee, then five jumping jacks.

Now repeat the cycle again, doing two repetitions of each exercise and ten jumping jacks. Then do the cycle with 3 repetitions of each exercise and 15 jumping jacks. Continue increasing repetitions until you get to 5 of each exercise and 25 jumping jacks.

That is a solid warm-up; the blood is *flowing*.

If your workout for the day is focused on a specific movement, do that movement with some light weights. For instance, if you are doing deadlifts, do some deadlifts with light weight. If you are doing clean and jerks, do some clean and jerks with a PVC pipe or just the bar. If you are doing squats, do some slow, deep, controlled squats with a very light weight, perfect form, and through the complete range of motion. These will not only get your body warm, but will also strengthen your muscle memory of the movements. Once you are warm, loose, and focused, you can start the workout.

WARNING: DON'T LIFT WEIGHTS THAT ARE TOO HEAVY FOR YOU OR DO MOVEMENTS WITHOUT PROPER TECHNIQUE OR YOU WILL GET INJURED.

BEGINNER SERIES ONE

PULL

Primary Work: 8 sets of max pull-ups

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups

MetCon: Run 400 meters 2 times

Directions: Do as many pull-ups as you can in 8 sets. Allow yourself 2-3 minutes rest between each set.

If you can do dead-hang pull-ups, do as many as you can each set, and then add 3-5 kipping pull-ups to the end of each set without dropping off the bar. If you do drop off the bar at the end of your dead-hang pull-ups, jump back up onto the bar immediately for 3-5 kipping pull-ups and then commence the 2-3 minute rest.

If you can't do any pull-ups at all, then use the ground or a stable box on the ground to jump up and get your chin over the bar. Once your chin is over the bar, hold yourself there as long as you can. This is called a "negative repetition."

PUSH

Primary Work: 8 sets of max push-ups

Gut: 2 minutes of leg-raises, 10-45 degrees

MetCon: Max burpees in 2 minutes

Directions: Do as many push-ups as you can in 8 sets. Allow yourself 2-3 minutes rest between each set.

Vary the width of your hands, anywhere from 6 inches closer than shoulder-width to 6 inches farther apart than shoulder-width.

If you can't do any push-ups at all, try doing them from your knees instead of toes. If even that is difficult, try leaning into a wall and see what you can do there.

LIFT

Primary Work: 8 handstand holds

Gut: 2 minutes of V-ups

MetCon: Run 400 meters 2 times, max effort

Directions: Hold the handstand position 8 times. Do not go all the way to muscle failure, but to muscle fatigue. Count how many seconds you hold the position. Allow yourself 2-3 minutes rest between each set.

Use a wall to balance yourself during the handstands. Try not to rely upon it too much.

If you cannot do a handstand at all, get in the push-up position with your feet touching a wall. Walk your feet up the wall and walk your hands closer to the wall. See how close you can get to vertical. Walk your feet and hands back down. Repeat that 8 times.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 50 forward lunges

Gut: 1 minute of crunches, 1 minute of reverse crunches

MetCon: Max burpees in 2 minutes

Directions: Perform 50 forward lunges for each leg, alternating legs with each repetition. Do the lunges in a steady controlled manner. Your knee should brush the ground on each repetition. Time yourself for your records, but the goal is not speed—the goal is controlled lunges at a steady

pace. If you reach muscle fatigue, take a 2-3 minute break and then continue. Repeat until you have done the 50 lunges.

BEGINNER SERIES TWO

PULL

Primary Work: 5 sets of pull-ups, maintaining reps

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups

MetCon: Run 400 meters 2 times

Directions: For the first-set workout, do your maximum set of pull-ups. If you can do dead-hang pull-ups, do them. If not, do kipping pull-ups. If you can't do kipping pull-ups, do jumping pull-ups or assisted pull-ups. For the remaining 4 sets, do as many pull-ups as you can, and once you drop off the bar, give yourself a 10-15 second rest before jumping up on the bar and doing more pull-ups until you reach the same number of pull-ups that you did in your first max set. This is called a "broken set," meaning you cannot perform the required repetitions, so you take a quick break and then continue. Once you have completed the broken set, take a 2-3 minute rest, then go again until you have completed 5 sets.

PUSH

Primary Work: 5 sets of push-ups, maintaining reps

Gut: 2 minutes of leg-raises, 10-45 degrees

MetCon: 2 minutes of max burpees

Directions: This workout is the same as the Pull workout in this series, but utilizing push-ups instead of pull-ups. For the first-set workout, do your maximum set of push-ups. If you can do full push-ups, do them. If not, do push-ups from your knees. If you can't do push-ups from the knees, do push-ups against the wall. For the remaining 4 sets, do as many push-ups as you can, and once you can't do any more, give yourself a 10-15 second rest and then continue doing more push-ups until you reach the same number of push-ups that you did in your first max set, using the broken set methodology. Once you have completed the broken set, take a 2-3 minute rest, then go again until you have completed 5 sets.

LIFT

Primary Work: 5 handstand negatives

Secondary Work: Arm circles, side, front, overhead

Gut: 2 minutes of V-ups

MetCon: Run 800 meters, once as hard as you can

Directions: Get into the handstand position and lower yourself as slowly as you can. Use a wall to maintain your balance. Once your head reaches the ground, drop your feet to the ground, stand up and rest for 2-3 minutes, then do it again for 5 full repetitions. Once that is complete do 1 minute each of arm circles to the side, to the front, and overhead.

SQUAT

Primary Work: Jump squats, squat thrusts, lunges

Gut: 1 minute of crunches, 1 minute of reverse crunches

MetCon: Run 1 mile

Directions: Set a timer for 3 sets of 20 seconds. Do 20 seconds of jump squats, 20 seconds of squat thrusts, and 20 seconds of lunges. Rest 2 minutes. Repeat this for a total of 3 rounds. Although you are trying to get maximum repetitions, do not sacrifice range of motion or form for increased repetitions.

BEGINNER SERIES THREE

PULL

Primary Work: Pull-up pyramid

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups

MetCon: 4 x 100-yard shuttle runs

Directions: This workout is recommended when you can do at least 5 pull-ups. Start by doing 1 pull-up. Rest for a bit. Do 2 pull-ups. Rest for a bit. Do 3 pull-ups. Rest for a bit. Continue to increase the number of pull-ups by 1 each set, until you do not beat your previous number. When you miss your previous number, drop off the bar, shake it out quickly, and then get up and complete the set. Now come back down the "pyramid" by decreasing 1 pull-up from the previous set. If you can't do all the pull-ups in a single set to get to the required number, do the required number in a broken set.

If you can do dead-hang pull-ups, do dead-hang; if not and you can do kipping pull-ups, do them. If you cannot do kipping pull-ups, use jumping pull-ups. For this and any pull-up workout, if you can utilize kipping or jumping pull-ups to complete your set without breaking it, do that sometimes. But sometimes drop off the bar, get a quick rest, and then complete the set.

For the shuttle runs, mark a start line and then a line at 5, 10, 15, and 20 yards. Start on the starting line and run to the 5 yard line, touch the line, run back to the start line; repeat this for the 10, 15, and 20 yard lines. Keep your time. Complete 4 sets. Take 2-3 minutes between sets.

PUSH

Primary Work: Push-up pyramid

Gut: 2 minutes of V-ups

MetCon: Run 1 mile, hard

Directions: This workout is recommended when you can do at least 6-10 push-ups. It follows the same pattern as the pull-up pyramid. Start by doing 1 push-up. Rest for a bit. Do 2 push-ups. Rest for a bit. Do 3 push-ups. Rest for a bit. Continue to increase the number of push-ups by 1 each set, until you do not beat your previous number. When you miss your previous number, rest quickly, and then continue with your push-ups until you complete the set. Now come back down the pyramid by one repetition of push-ups per set. If you can't do all the push-ups in a single set to get to the required number, do the required number in a broken set.

If you can't do regular push-ups, do them from the knees. If that is still not achievable, do them on an incline, such as against a wall or with your hands on a table or a bench.

For this and any push-up workout, if you can utilize push-ups from the knees to complete your set without breaking it, do that sometimes. But sometimes take a quick rest, and then complete the set.

LIFT

Primary Work: 4 handstand holds

Secondary Work: Arm haulers

Tertiary Work: Arm circles, side, front, overhead

Gut: Hold a plank for 1 minute

MetCon: 1 squat thrust and 5 jumping jacks repeatedly for 2 minutes for max number of burpees

Directions: Do a handstand hold. Hold until muscle fatigue, not muscle failure. Once complete, do 1 minute of arm haulers, then one minute of arm circles for each position: side, front, and overhead. Once complete, rest for about 2-3 minutes and repeat the circuit 3 more times.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 5 sets of 10 squats/5 forward lunges

Gut: 1 minute of crunches, 1 minute of reverse crunches, hold 1-minute plank

MetCon: Run 400 meters 2 times

Directions: Do 10 squats followed by 5 forward lunges for 5 sets. Rest as needed, but try to maintain a steady pace and move through the exercises with minimum rest. Maintaining good form trumps speed. Lunges are performed with 1 repetition for each leg.

Run 400 meters, rest 2-3 minutes, then run another 400 meters.

BEGINNER SERIES FOUR

PULL

Primary Work: 5 sets of pull-up sprints, 1 minute on, 2 minutes rest

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups

MetCon: 4 x 100-yard shuttle runs

Directions: This workout is to gain strength and some endurance in your pull-up muscles. Set a timer for 1 minute of work and 2 minutes of rest. During the 1 minute of work, do as many pull-ups as you can. These will likely be broken sets, meaning you will be dropping off the bar to rest even during your work set. Make the rest during the work set as short as possible (5-7 seconds) before jumping back on the bar and continuing to do pull-ups until the minute is complete. Once the minute is over, rest for 2 minutes, then do another minute of pull-ups. Repeat this until you have done 5 sets of pull-ups.

If you can do dead-hang pull-ups, do dead-hang; if not and you can do kipping pull-ups, do them. If you cannot do kipping pull-ups, use jumping pull-ups. You can also utilize all three types of pull-ups to maximize the number of pull-ups you do during the minute of work.

For the shuttle runs, mark a start line and then a line at 5, 10, 15, and 20 yards. Start on the starting line and run to the 5 yard line, touch the line, run back to the start line; repeat this for the 10, 15, and 20 yard lines. Keep your time. Complete 4 sets. Take 2-3 minutes between sets.

PUSH

Primary Work: 1 minute of push-up sprints and 2 minutes rest for 5 sets

Gut: Hold 1-minute plank

MetCon: 2 minutes of burpees

Directions: Similar to the pull-up sprints, this workout is to gain strength and some endurance in your push-up muscles. Set a timer for 1 minute of work and 2 minutes of rest. During the 1 minute of work, do as many push-ups as you can. These will likely be broken sets, meaning you might have to rest even during your work set. Make the rest during the work set as short as possible (5-7 seconds) before continuing to do push-ups until the minute is complete. Once the minute is over, rest for 2 minutes, then do another minute of push-ups. Repeat this until you have done 5 sets of push-ups.

Once again, for this and any push-up workout, if you have exhausted your push-up muscles, and you can utilize push-ups from the knees to complete your set without breaking it, do that sometimes. But sometimes take a quick rest, and then complete the set utilizing strict push-ups with the feet on the ground.

LIFT

Primary Work: 5 minutes of handstand holds

Secondary Work: Arm haulers

Tertiary Work: Arm circles, side, front, overhead

Gut: 2 minutes of V-ups

MetCon: Run 400 meters 2 times, max effort

Directions: Hold the handstand position for a total of 5 minutes. Do not do this workout if you cannot hold a handstand position for at least 1 minute. If you cannot hold a handstand position for at least 1 minute, go back to the Lift workout in Series 1, 2, or 3.

For this workout go into the handstand position using a wall for balance. Stay there as long as you can without reaching complete muscle failure and falling onto your head. Count the seconds to track

how long you stayed up. Repeat sets until you have reached a total amount of 5 minutes in the handstand position.

Once complete, do 1 minute of arm haulers, then 1 minute of arm circles for each position: side, front, and overhead.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 50 forward lunges and 50 squats

Gut: 1 minute of crunches, 1 minute of reverse crunches

MetCon: Max burpees in 2 minutes

Directions: Perform 50 forward lunges for each leg, alternating legs with each repetition. Do the lunges in a steady controlled manner. Your knee should brush the ground on each repetition. Time yourself for your records, but the goal is not speed—the goal is controlled lunges at a steady pace. If you reach muscle fatigue, take a 2–3 minute break and then continue. Repeat until you have done the 50 lunges. Once you have completed 50 lunges, do 50 body-weight squats.

Again, the goal is not speed, but controlled movement with the fullest range of motion you are capable of. If you need to stop and rest, that is fine. Rest for a minute or two, then continue.

If you lose your balance at the bottom of the squat, it may help to put a 2-inch block under your heels during the squat. Over time, you can move down to a 1.5-inch block, then a 1-inch block, then .5-inch block and eventually you will have improved your flexibility and mobility to where you no longer need a block.

INTERMEDIATE SERIES ONE

PULL

Primary Work: 8 sets of max pull-ups/chin-ups

Secondary Work: Hang cleans

Tertiary work: Straight-bar reverse curls and curls

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups, 2 minutes of leg-raises

MetCon: Run 400 meters 3 times

Directions:

- Do a set of maximum pull-ups. Once the maximum has been reached, drop off the bar, rest for 15-20 seconds, then get back on the bar with the chin-up grip and do as many chin-ups as you can. Once both rapid-fire sets are complete, rest for 2-3 minutes and then do your next set. Complete a total of 8 sets. Attempt to use dead-hang pull-ups for sets requiring maximum numbers. If you can get a couple more repetitions with kipping, then do so.
- Do 6 sets of hang cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Once complete, do a set of reverse-grip curls to exhaustion (aiming for 6-10 repetitions), then switch to a normal grip and complete another maximum set. Rest approximately 1 minute, then repeat for a total of 6 sets.
- Gut: Complete 2 minutes of sit-ups and 2 minutes of leg raises.
- MetCon: Complete a 400-meter sprint 3 times.

PUSH

Primary Work: 8 sets of max dips/push-ups

Secondary Work: Hang snatch movement

Gut: 100 V-ups **MetCon:** Max burpees in 3 minutes

Directions:

- Do a maximum set of dips. Once the maximum has been reached, drop off the dip bars and do a set of maximum push-ups. Rest for 2-3 minutes and then complete the next set. Perform a total of 8 sets.
- Use a PVC pipe to perform the hang snatch. Do 40 repetitions with perfect form.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups. Break the set if you have to.
- MetCon: Do the burpees. Fast.

LIFT

Primary Work: 8 sets of handstand push-ups and deadlifts

Secondary Work: Barbell press

Gut: 4 sets of knees to elbows, max reps

MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

Directions:

- Do 8 sets of maximum handstand push-ups followed by 1 minute of rest followed by deadlift. For the deadlift, utilize a weight you can lift for 6-8 repetitions. You will get fewer repetitions of each exercise the more sets you do. That is okay. Keep form correct to avoid injury, especially with the deadlift.
- Once initial work is done, do some barbell presses with a moderate weight that you can get 4-8 repetitions of. Do 5 sets of presses.
- Gut: For the knees to elbows, hang from a pull-up bar and raise your knees to touch your elbows. Do the max reps and then rest 2-3 minutes. Perform 4 sets.
- MetCon: Complete 6 sets of 100-meter shuttle runs with 1 minute of rest between work.

SQUAT

Primary Work: Back squats Secondary Work: Overhead squats
Tertiary Work: Jump squats Gut: 3-minute plank
MetCon: 2-mile run

Directions:

- Perform 50 back squats with half your body weight. Break up the set as needed to complete the work.
- Perform 50 overhead squats with a PVC pipe.
- Perform 50 jump squats.
- Gut: Hold the plank position for 3 minutes.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles. Run at a good pace to get metabolic conditioning, but also to loosen the legs after the higher-intensity work. Run hard, but not with an all-out effort.

INTERMEDIATE SERIES TWO

PULL

Primary Work: 50 dead-hang pull-ups and 100 kipping pull-ups for time

Secondary Work: Cleans

Tertiary Work: Straight-bar reverse curls and curls

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups, 2 minutes of leg-raises

MetCon: Max burpee pull-ups in 5 minutes

Directions:

- Complete 50 dead-hang pull-ups followed by 100 kipping pull-ups as quickly as possible. Break up sets as needed to complete.
- Do 6 sets of cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Once complete, do a set of reverse-grip curls to exhaustion (with a weight that allows you to complete 6-10 repetitions), then switch to a normal grip and complete another maximum set. Rest approximately 1 minute, then repeat for a total of 6 sets.
- Gut: Complete 2 minutes of sit-ups and 2 minutes of leg-raises.
- MetCon: Do the maximum number of burpee pull-ups you can in 5 minutes.

PUSH

Primary Work: 50 dips and 100 push-ups for time

Secondary Work: Snatch movement

Gut: 100 V-ups

MetCon: Max burpees in 3 minutes

Directions:

- Do 50 dips followed by 100 strict push-ups in as short a time as possible.
- Use a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight to perform the snatch. Do 40 repetitions with perfect form.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups. Break the set if you have to.
- MetCon: Do the burpees. Fast.

LIFT

Primary Work: 50 handstand push-ups and 50 body-weight deadlifts for time

Secondary Work: Barbell press **Tertiary Work:** Clean and jerk

Gut: 4 sets of knees to elbows, max reps

MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

Directions:

- Do 50 handstand push-ups followed by 50 deadlifts with your body weight. Keep form correct to avoid injury, especially with the deadlift.
- Once initial work is done, do some barbell presses with a moderate weight that you can get 4-8 repetitions of. Do 5 sets of presses.
- For the clean and jerk, use a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight to practice perfect form for 40 repetitions.
- Gut: For the knees to elbows, hang from a pull-up bar and raise your knees to touch your elbows. Do as many as you can, then rest 2-3 minutes. Perform 4 sets.
- MetCon: Complete 6 sets of 100-meter shuttle runs with 1 minute of rest between work.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 6 max sets of back squats with 100% body weight

Secondary Work: 6 sets of front squats with 50% body weight

Tertiary Work: Overhead squats

Gut: 3-minute plank

MetCon: 2-mile run

Directions:

- Complete 6 sets of maximum repetitions of the back squat with your body weight on the bar. Rest 2–3 minutes between each set. Maintain correct form. If form weakens, stop, rest, and move on to the next set.
- Complete 6 sets of maximum repetitions of the front squat with half your body weight on the bar. Again, form is paramount; if your form weakens, your set is complete.
- Perform 50 overhead squats with a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight.
- Gut: Hold the plank position for 3 minutes.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles. Run at a good pace to get metabolic conditioning, but also to loosen the legs after the higher-intensity work. Run hard, but not with an all-out effort.

INTERMEDIATE SERIES THREE

PULL

Primary Work: 5 sets of L-sit pull-ups, L-tuck pull-ups, dead-hang pull-ups, kipping pull-ups, chin-ups

Secondary Work: Cleans

Tertiary Work: Straight-bar reverse curls and curls

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups, 2 minutes of leg-raises

MetCon: 20, 15, 10, 5 of pull-ups/cleans

Directions:

- Do a max set of L-sit pull-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of L-tuck pull-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of dead-hang pull-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of kipping pull-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of chin-ups. Rest 15 seconds and repeat this 5 times.
- Do 4 sets of cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Once complete, do a set of reverse-grip curls to exhaustion (with a weight that allows you to complete 6-10 repetitions), then switch to a normal grip and complete another maximum set. Rest approximately 1 minute, then repeat for a total of 6 sets.
- Gut: Do 2 minutes of sit-ups and 2 minutes of leg-raises
- MetCon: Complete sets of 20, 15, 10, and 5 repetitions alternating between pull-ups and cleans. For the cleans, use the heaviest weight you can without breaking up your sets.

PUSH

Primary Work: 5 sets of dips, clap push-ups, deep push-ups, triceps push-ups

Secondary Work: Snatch movement Gut: 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists

MetCon: Max burpees in 3 minutes

Directions:

- Do a maximum set of dips, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of clap push-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of deep push-ups, rest 15 seconds; do a max set of triceps push-ups. Upon completion, rest 2-3 minutes and then repeat this series for 5. For the deep push-ups, simply find a way to elevate your hands off the floor about 6 inches so you can go all the way down in the push-up position to the bottom of the range of motion.
- Use a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight to perform the snatch. Do 40 repetitions with perfect form.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists. Break the sets if you have to.
- MetCon: Do the burpees. Fast.

LIFT

Primary Work: 8 max sets of HSPU (Handstand Push-ups) and 8 sets of body-weight deadlifts

Secondary work: Clean and jerk movement drills

Gut: 4 sets of hanging straight leg-raises, max reps

MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

Directions:

- Do 8 max sets of HSPUs followed by a set of deadlifts with your body weight on the bar. Do not go to complete muscle failure on deadlifts. Instead, go to muscle fatigue and then stop so you can keep form correct to avoid injury.
- For the clean and jerk, use an extremely light weight (approximately 25% of body weight) to practice perfect form for 30 single repetitions.
- Gut: Hang on the pull-up bar and raise your straightened legs as high as you can. Do max reps and then rest 2-3 minutes. Perform 4 sets.
- MetCon: Complete 6 sets of 100-meter shuttle runs with 1 minute of rest between work.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 8 max sets of front squats ~50% body weight

Secondary Work: 3 max sets of back squats ~100% body weight

Tertiary Work: Overhead squat movement

Gut: 3-minute plank MetCon: 2-mile run

Directions:

- Front squat with ~50% body weight for 8 sets. Rest approximately 2 minutes between each set. Do not go to muscle failure, only muscle fatigue. Failure to maintain proper form can result in serious injury.
- Back squat with ~100% body weight for 3 sets. Rest approximately 2 minutes between each set. Maintain proper form and do not go to muscle failure, only muscle fatigue.
- Do 50 overhead squats with a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles at a good pace to get metabolic conditioning, but also to loosen the legs after the higher intensity work. Run hard, but not with an all-out effort.

INTERMEDIATE SERIES FOUR

PULL

Primary Work: Every Minute On The Minute (EMOTM): pull-up pyramid **Secondary Work:** Cleans

Tertiary Work: Straight-bar reverse curls and curls

Gut: 2 minutes of sit-ups, 2 minutes of leg-raises

MetCon: Max burpee pull-ups in 5 minutes

Directions:

- Set a timer for 1 minute. The first minute do 1 pull-up, the second minute do 2 pull-ups, the third minute do 3 pull-ups. Start with dead-hang pull-ups and transition into kipping pull-ups as needed to achieve the required number. Continue to increase the number of pull-ups by 1 each set, until you do not beat your previous number. Complete that number of pull-ups by breaking up the set and finishing. Then come back down the pyramid breaking up sets as needed and resting 1-2 minutes between sets.
- Do 6 sets of cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form. Once complete, do a set of reverse-grip curls to exhaustion (with a weight that allows you to complete 6-10 repetitions), then switch to a normal grip and complete another maximum set. Rest approximately 1 minute, then repeat for a total of 6 sets.
- Gut: Complete 2 minutes of sit-ups and 2 minutes of leg-raises.
- MetCon: Do sets of 20, 15, 10, and 5 repetitions alternating between pull-ups and cleans. For the cleans, use the heaviest weight you can without breaking up your sets.

PUSH

Primary Work: On the minute dip pyramid

Secondary Work: On the minute push-up pyramid

Tertiary Work: Snatch movement **Gut:** 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists

MetCon: Max burpees in 3 minutes

Directions:

- Set a timer for 1 minute. The first minute do 1 dip, the second minute do 2 dips, the third minute do 3 dips. Use slow, deep, full-range-of-motion dips. Continue to increase the number of pull-ups by 1 each set, until you do not complete the required number. Complete that number of dips by breaking up the set and finishing. Then come back down the pyramid breaking up sets as needed and resting 1-2 minutes between sets.
- Once dips are completed, do the same thing again, but using strict, full-range-of-motion push-ups.
- Use a PVC pipe or an extremely light weight to perform the snatch. Do 40 repetitions with perfect form.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists. Break the sets if you have to.
- MetCon: Do the burpees. Fast.

LIFT

Primary Work: Tabata body-weight deadlifts followed by Tabata HSPUs

Secondary Work: Clean and jerk movement drills

Gut: 4 max sets of hanging straight leg-raises

MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

Directions:

- For the Tabata protocol, set a timer for 8 sets of 20 seconds of work followed by 10 seconds of rest. Use this protocol to do the max number of deadlift repetitions with body weight on the bar. Strict form is paramount to avoid injury. Once the deadlifts are complete, do the same protocol for HSPUs.
- For the clean and jerks, use an extremely light weight (approximately 25% of body weight) to practice perfect form for 30 single repetitions.

- Gut: Hang on the pull-up bar and raise your straightened legs as high as you can. Do max reps and then rest 2 minutes. Perform 4 sets.
- MetCon: Complete 6 sets of 100-meter shuttle runs with 1 minute of rest between work.

SQUAT

Primary Work: 8 max sets of back squats ~100% body weight

Secondary Work: 3 max sets of front squats ~50% body weight

Gut: 3-minute plank

MetCon: 2-mile run

Directions:

- Back squat max reps with ~100% body weight for 8 sets. Rest approximately 2 minutes between each set. Do not go to muscle failure, only muscle fatigue. Keep form right and correct. Failure to maintain proper form can result in serious injury.
- Front squat max reps with ~50% body weight for 3 sets. Rest approximately 2 minutes between each set. Maintain proper form and do not go to muscle failure, only muscle fatigue.
- Gut: Hold the plank position for 3 minutes.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles at a good pace to get metabolic conditioning, but also to loosen the legs after the high-intensity work. Run hard, but not with an all-out effort.

ADVANCED SERIES ONE

PULL

Primary Work: 5 sets of weighted pull-ups and pull-ups

Secondary Work: Hang cleans Gut: 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists

MetCon: 25 pull-ups/run 400 meters x 4

Directions:

- Utilize a weight belt or weight vest of ~20% of your body weight. Complete 5 sets of dead-hang weighted pull-ups, resting 1-2 minutes between each set. Then complete 5 sets of weighted kipping pull-ups, resting 1-2 minutes between each set. Next, remove the weight belt and complete 5 sets of dead-hang pull-ups. Finally do 5 max sets of non-weighted kipping pull-ups.
- Do 6 sets of hang cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists.
- MetCon: Do 25 pull-ups, then run 400 meters. Repeat for a total of 4 rounds.

PUSH

Primary Work: Weighted ring-dips, weighted bar-dips

Gut: 5 sets of hanging leg-raises

MetCon: Power snatch/clap push-ups/burpees 20, 15, 10, 5

Directions:

- Utilize a weight belt or weight vest of ~20% of your body weight. Complete 5 sets of weighted ring-dips, resting 1-2 minutes between each set. Then complete 5 sets of weighted bar-dips, resting 1-2 minutes between each set. Next, remove the weight belt and complete 5 sets of ring-dips. Finally, do 5 max sets of unweighted dips.
- Gut: Do 5 sets of hanging leg-raises.
- MetCon: Perform rounds of power snatches, clap push-ups, and burpees with 20, 15, 10, and 5 repetitions as fast as possible. For the power snatches use ~30-40% of your body weight.

LIFT

Primary Work: Snatch, clean and jerk, deadlift

Gut: GHD sit-ups x 100

MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

Directions:

- Form and technique are absolutely critical. Sacrificing proper form will not make you stronger; it will only make you injured. Attending a live, hands-on coaching program by a professional for these lifts is highly recommended prior to these workouts. If you cannot perform these lifts with strict technique and form, DO NOT DO THEM. YOU WILL GET INJURED.
- Begin snatching 3-5 repetitions per weight. Increase weight toward maximum 5-20 pounds each lift, looking to reach your maximum in approximately 8 sets. Once you have missed a weight 2 times, switch to the clean and jerk. Continue to add weight in 5-20 pound increments until you reach your maximum, which you are trying to do in approximately 6 sets. Once you have missed 2 clean and jerks, switch to the deadlift. Continue to add weight in increments of 10-50 pounds until you have reached your maximum. Once you have reached your maximum, do 2 singles at that weight.
- Gut: Do 100 GHD sit-ups.
- MetCon: 6 x 100-meter shuttle runs

SQUAT

Primary Work: Overhead squat, front squat, back squat

Gut: Hanging leg-raises

MetCon: 2-mile run

Directions:

- Maintain strict form when doing these exercises. Failure to do so can and will result in serious injury. Do not let your ego dictate the weight you use.
- Rest approximately 2 minutes between each of these sets. Begin overhead squats in 3-5 repetitions per weight. Increase weight toward maximum 5-20 pounds each lift, looking to reach your maximum in approximately 8 sets. Once you have missed a weight, switch to the front squat. Continue to add weight in 5-20 pound increments until you reach your maximum, which you are trying to do in approximately 6 sets. Once you have missed a front squat, switch to the back squat. Continue to add weight in increments of 10-20 pounds until you have reached your maximum. Once you have reached your maximum, do 2 singles at that weight.
- Gut: 5 sets of max hanging leg-raises.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles at a good pace, but not with an all-out effort. The goal is to loosen the legs after heavy work.

Again: During the lifts, keep form tight and correct.

ADVANCED SERIES TWO

PULL

Primary Work: 30 muscle-ups, 100 dead-hang pull-ups, 100 kipping pull-ups for time

Secondary Work: Hang cleans

Tertiary Work: Reverse curls/curls

Gut: 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists, 100 sit-ups, 100 reverse crunches

MetCon: 20, 15, 10, 5 of pull-ups/cleans

Directions:

- Do 30 muscle-ups, followed by 100 dead-hang pull-ups, followed by 100 kipping pull-ups as fast as possible.
- Do 6 sets of hang cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Complete 5 sets of reverse curls followed by curls, with a weight that allows you to complete 8-12 repetitions.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists.
- MetCon: Perform 4 sets of cleans/pull-ups with these repetitions: 20, 15, 10, 5. Utilize ~60% body weight for the cleans.

PUSH

Primary Work: Ring-dips, dips, ring push-ups, push-ups

Gut: 5 sets of hanging leg-raises

MetCon: 100 burpees for time

Directions:

- Do 100 ring-dips, followed by 100 dips, followed by 100 ring push-ups, followed by 100 regular push-ups as fast as possible.
- Gut: Do 5 max sets of hanging leg-raises.
- MetCon: Complete 100 burpees for time.

LIFT

Primary Work: Deadlift

Gut: 100 GHD sit-ups

MetCon: Circuit HSPU, clean and jerk, deadlift

Directions:

- Form and technique are absolutely critical. Sacrificing proper form will not make you stronger; it will only make you injured. Attending a live, hands-on coaching program by a professional for these lifts is highly recommended prior to these workouts. If you cannot perform these deadlifts with strict technique and form, DO NOT DO THEM. YOU WILL GET INJURED.
- Perform 8-10 sets of deadlift, building up to 4 sets with a weight that allows you to complete 2-4 repetitions.
- Gut: Do 100 GHD sit-ups.
- MetCon: Set up a bar with ~150% of your body weight, and one bar with ~60% of your body weight. For time, perform 4 rounds of HSPUs, clean and jerks with ~60% body weight, and deadlifts with ~150% body weight with these repetitions: 20, 15, 10, 5.

SQUAT

Primary Work: Back squat

Gut: 100 sit-ups with ~20% body weight on chest

MetCon: Overhead squat/back squat/run

Directions:

- Maintain strict form when doing these exercises. Failure to do so can and will result in serious injury. Do not let your ego dictate the weight you use.

- Perform 8-10 sets of back squats, building up to 4 sets with a weight that allows you to complete 2-4 repetitions.
- Gut: With a plate on your chest of approximately 20% body weight, perform 100 sit-ups.
- MetCon: For time, perform 4 rounds of overhead squats with ~60% body weight, followed by back squat with 100% body weight for repetitions of 20, 15, 10, 5. Run 400 meters between each round.

Again: During the lifts, keep form tight and correct.

ADVANCED SERIES THREE

PULL

Primary Work: 3 minutes on 1-minute rest: muscle-ups, L-sit pull-ups, L-tuck pull-ups, dead-hang pull-ups, dead-hang chin-ups, kipping pull-ups

Secondary Work: Hang cleans

Tertiary Work: Reverse curls/curls

Gut: 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists,

MetCon: 20, 15, 10, 5 of pull-ups/cleans

Directions:

- Set your timer for 3 minutes of work followed by 1 minute of rest. Perform as many muscle-ups as you can in 3 minutes, then rest 1 minute. Repeat the same pattern for L-sit pull-ups, L-tuck pull-ups, dead-hang pull-ups, dead-hang chin-ups, and kipping pull-ups. Once your time is up for kipping pull-ups, continue doing kipping pull-ups until you reach 100.
- Do 6 sets of hang cleans, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Complete 5 sets of reverse curls followed by curls, with a weight that allows you to complete 8-12 repetitions.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists.
- MetCon: Perform 4 sets of cleans/pull-ups with these repetitions: 20, 15, 10, 5.

PUSH

Primary Work: 3 minutes on 1-minute rest: ring-dips, ring push-ups, dips, clap push-ups, deep push-ups, push-ups

Secondary Work: Snatch movement

Gut: 5-minute plank **MetCon:** Burpees 3x3

Directions:

- Set your timer for 3 minutes of work followed by 1 minute of rest. Perform as many ring-dips as you can in 3 minutes, then rest 1 minute. Repeat the same pattern for ring push-ups, dips, clap push-ups, deep push-ups, and regular push-ups. Once your time is up for push-ups, continue doing push-ups until you reach 100.
- Do 40 repetitions of the snatch movement with an extremely light weight.
- Gut: Hold the plank position for 5 minutes.
- MetCon: Perform 3 rounds of max burpees in 3 minutes with 1 minute of rest between rounds.

LIFT

Primary Work: Clean and jerk **Gut:** 100 GHD sit-ups

MetCon: Circuit HSPUs, clean and jerks, deadlifts

Directions:

- Form and technique are absolutely critical. Sacrificing proper form will not make you stronger; it will only make you injured. Attending a live, hands-on coaching program by a professional for these lifts is highly recommended prior to these workouts. If you cannot perform these lifts with strict technique and form, DO NOT DO THEM. YOU WILL GET INJURED.
- Perform 8-10 sets of the clean and jerks, building up to 4 sets with a weight that allows you to complete 2-4 repetitions.
- Gut: Do 100 V-ups followed by 100 Russian twists holding 10-25 pounds.
- MetCon: Set up a bar with ~180% of your body weight, and a bar with ~80% of your body weight. For time, perform 10 rounds of HSPUs, clean and jerks with ~80% body weight, and deadlifts with ~180% body weight with these repetitions: 10, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1.

SQUAT

Primary Work: Overhead squat, front squat, back squat

Gut: 100 sit-ups with ~20% body weight on chest **MetCon:** Run

Directions:

- Maintain strict form when doing these exercises. Failure to do so can and will result in serious injury. Do not let your ego dictate the weight you use.
- Perform 50 overhead squats with ~60% body weight. Perform 50 front squats with ~80% body weight. Perform 50 back squats with body weight.
- Gut: With a plate on your chest of approximately 20% body weight, perform 100 sit-ups.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles at a decent pace.

Again: During the lifts, keep form tight and correct. Form is paramount. If form starts to slip, go lighter in weight.

ADVANCED SERIES FOUR

PULL

Primary Work: Muscle-ups, L-sit pull-ups, L-tuck pull-ups, dead-hang pull-ups, kipping pull-ups, dead-hang chin-ups

Secondary Work: Hang cleans

Tertiary Work: Reverse curls/curls

Gut: 100 V-ups, 100 Russian twists, 100 sit-ups, 100 reverse crunches

MetCon: Every Minute On The Minute (EMOTM): burpees/pull-ups

Directions:

- Perform as many muscle-ups as you can in one set. Next do a set of max L-sit pull-ups, then max L-tuck pull-ups, max dead-hang pull-ups, max kipping pull-ups, and finally max chin-ups. Repeat this circuit 5 times, taking minimal rest between sets.
- Do 6 sets of dead-hang chin-ups, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Complete 5 sets of reverse curls followed by curls, with a weight that allows you to complete 8-12 repetitions.
- Gut: Perform 100 each of V-ups, Russian twists, sit-ups, and reverse crunches.
- MetCon: On the minute, perform 5 burpees and then maximum pull-ups for a total of 6 minutes.

PUSH

Primary Work: Ring-dips, ring push-ups, bar-dips, clap push-ups, deep push-ups, push-ups

Secondary Work: Hang snatches

Gut: Ring L-sits

MetCon: On the minute: burpees/ring-dips.

Directions:

- Perform as many ring-dips as you can in one set. Next do a set of max ring push-ups, then max bar-dips, max clap push-ups, max deep push-ups, and finally max regular push-ups. Repeat this circuit 5 times, taking minimal rest between sets.
- Do 6 sets of hang snatches, with a weight that allows you to do 3-6 repetitions per set while maintaining good form.
- Gut: Complete 5 max sets of ring L-sits.
- MetCon: On the minute, perform 5 burpees and then maximum ring-dips for a total of 6 minutes.

LIFT

Primary Work: Clean and jerk

Gut: Complete 5 sets of hanging windshield wipers.

MetCon: Circuit HSPUs, clean and jerks, deadlifts

Directions:

- Form and technique are absolutely critical. Sacrificing proper form will not make you stronger; it will only make you injured. Attending a live, hands-on coaching program by a professional for these lifts is highly recommended prior to these workouts. If you cannot perform these lifts with strict technique and form, DO NOT DO THEM. YOU WILL GET INJURED.
- Perform 8-10 sets of the clean and jerks, building up to 4 sets with a weight that allows you to complete 2-4 repetitions.
- Gut: Complete 5 sets of hanging windshield wipers.
- MetCon: Perform 30 repetitions of clean and jerks with ~60% body weight without putting the bar down, rest 2 minutes; perform 20 repetitions with the same weight, rest 2 minutes; perform 10 repetitions.

SQUAT

Primary Work: Overhead squat, back squat

Gut: 100 sit-ups with ~20% body weight on chest

MetCon: Run

Directions:

- Maintain strict form when doing these exercises. Failure to do so can and will result in serious injury. Do not let your ego dictate the weight you use.
- Perform 8-10 overhead squats, increasing weight each set until you reach failure. Rest 2-3 minutes between sets. Once failure is reached, drop the weight back down to the last weight you made and perform 3 more max sets.
- Once overhead squats are complete, add ~20% to that weight. This weight should be a weight that you can back squat about 10 times. Now perform 20 back squats without racking the bar. This should be the most brutal set of squats you have ever done. From repetition 12 on, each rep should require total focus, concentration, grit, and pure will.
- Gut: With a plate on your chest of approximately 20% body weight, perform 100 sit-ups.
- MetCon: Run 2 miles at a decent pace.

Again: During the lifts, keep form tight and correct. Form is paramount. If form starts to slip, go lighter in weight.

ROAD WARRIOR WORKOUTS

Many jobs require travel. Travel can make working out difficult.

BUT IT DOESN'T MAKE IT IMPOSSIBLE.

There are many ways to get good workouts on the road.

Now. If you are going to a location for an extended period of time, such as a military deployment, it is important to plan ahead to either bring or have access to the right equipment so you can continue working out. In the civilian sector, if you are going to spend an extended amount of time in an area, this might mean joining a local gym.

Whether you bring equipment, utilize someone else's, or join a local gym, it is almost always possible to set up or gain access to some kind of solid workout area and stay on the program.

Traveling for shorter time periods, for one to four days at a time, can sometimes cause more disruption than long trips. The difficulty in bringing gear while traveling is one issue because checking bags is a gamble and time consumer in an already compressed schedule.

So. When I travel, I travel light. I carry a chalk bag with chalk, wristbands, a notebook to track my workout, and some one-inch tubular nylon and a hard ball (slightly larger than a lacrosse ball) for doing mobility and maintenance work.

If the hotel has a gym, I get in there and use it. Of course, hotel gyms are usually pretty pathetic. They don't have very heavy weights, they might not have a pull-up bar or a dip bar, and they are generally small. But I get in there and improvise. I will do what I can to reproduce my real workout. Due to a lack of weight, my workout usually consists of lower weights and higher reps. If there is any kind of pull-up bar,

I utilize it. If not, sometimes I will hang a towel over one of the machines in the gym and do pull-ups on that. Many times I have done dips between two treadmills. I will use benches to jump over or on, jump ropes to push the heart rate up, and any other object they have in the gym that I can use to get my blood flowing.

I consider these workouts more of a maintenance routine than a workout that will result in serious progression.

Sometimes, the hotel doesn't have a gym or it is just worthless, or I have a very tight schedule and don't have much time. In those cases, I often just do a hotel room workout on the floor.

The hotel room workouts are rudimentary and, again, are usually not geared toward any great advancement in my physical conditioning. They are more focused on maintaining the discipline of working out early, and getting the benefits that come from working out: blood flow to the brain, releasing endorphins, and overall kick-starting my day. Also, I do try to

plan my schedule to do several days' worth of murderous physical training before I go on the road so that my body is in need of a rest, and I can use some simple workouts for recovery.

That being said, I have some quick workouts to keep me on track when I am on the road.

For a pull workout, I will try to find some kind of pull-up bar. Usually I can find one in the hotel parking garage (make sure they are solid!) or outside on a tree or a piece of scaffolding or anything that might work. Then I will do 8-10 sets of pull-ups in a very slow, controlled, dead-hang manner focusing on the negative-coming down slow. I might also do various types of pull-ups: chin-ups, chest-to-bar, typewriter, and countless other variations. If I need to get the blood flowing, I will do some burpee pull-ups and some gut.

For a push workout in the hotel room I will do push-ups-lots of them. Reps of 80, 70, 60, 50, 40, 30, 20, 10. Another variation is reps of 10, 10, 10, 10, 10, 100, 50, 50, 33, 33, 33, 25, 25, 25, 25, 20, 20, 20, 20, 20, 10, 10, 10, 10, 10. On top of that I will do some burpees-100 for time. And of course some gut.

For lift day, I will do handstand push-ups, 8-10 max sets, I will mix in some arm haulers, some jumping jacks, arm circles, and of course.. burpees.

If I end up in a hotel room for squat day, there are plenty of options. One I like to do is pistols (one-legged squats) and jump squats. I will do 10 pistols each leg, then 20 jump squats; then I do 9 pistols each leg and 18 jump squats; then 8 and 16 right on down to 1 pistol each leg and 2 jump squats. Other possibilities are lunges, split jumps, mountain climbers, squat thrusts, and, yes, burpees.

If I am really sore and need a recovery day, I will do some good stretching, a little gut, some drills from MobilityWOD, with 100

burpees mixed in to get the blood going.

Like I said, most of these routines are more about maintaining fitness on the road for a couple of days, getting the blood flowing to wake up and be alert, and maintaining my discipline.

If I need a real workout, I will simply increase the volume of any of these hotel workouts. Any one of these workouts can become vicious when volume and intensity are turned up. I have destroyed myself many times in hotel rooms all over the world. It just takes some creativity and, of course, **WILL**.

So. When you are on the road. Don't get lazy. Don't get complacent. Don't use the road as an excuse.

Get creative. Get *aggressive*. Get it *done*.
When you are on the road,

STAY ON THE PATH.

CONTINUED IMPROVEMENT AND EXPLORATION

There is much more out there than what I have covered.

Check out kettlebells. They are an outstanding way to get in shape. Swings, snatches, goblet squats, high-pulls, lunge-presses, Turkish get-ups, weighted pull-ups, push-ups with rows—the list is infinite. Add them to your game to get it on. Use them to supplement your workouts or do some all-kettlebell days.

There are also an unbelievable number of movements that can be taken from gymnastics. The muscle-up is a staple of my workouts, and it is a basic movement in gymnastics. Other moves like hanging leg-lifts, L-sits, V-ups, front and back levers, all kinds of multi-plane pushes and presses. The list goes on and on. Find a gym or a coach or an online program to start getting after some of the hardest body-weight exercises in the world.

And don't stop with kettlebells and gymnastics. Keep looking. Keep *experimenting*. Keep **exploring**.

Keep getting better.

DO

Don't just read this book.
Don't just listen to the podcast.
Don't just watch videos online.

Don't just take notes.
Don't just study them.
Don't just share them with your friends.

Don't just plan.
Don't just mark your calendar.
Don't just "get motivated."

Don't just talk.
Don't just think.
Don't just dream.

No. None of that matters.

The only thing that matters is that you actually do.

SO:

DO.

About the author



JOCKO WILLINK served 20 years as a Navy SEAL. He was in combat in Iraq during the Battle of Ramadi, a conflict that resulted in numerous medals for his efforts. After his tours, Willink served as a Navy SEAL instructor before forming Echelon Front with Leif Babin, a leadership training group that uses the lessons and expertise the pair learned as SEALs to train leaders beyond the military. Willink lives in San Diego, California. He is the author of the #1 *New York Times* bestseller *Extreme Ownership*, the children's book *Way of the Warrior Kid*, and the *New York Times* bestseller *Discipline Equals Freedom*, and the creator of the popular podcast, JOCKO PODCAST. You can sign up for email updates [here](#).



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